BY ORDER OF THE
SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

HEADQUARTERS OPERATING
INSTRUCTION 36-28

7 JULY 2026

Personnel

MEDAL OF HONOR -- PROCESSING NOMINATIONS AND ORGANIZING CEREMONIES

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This Headquarters Operating Instruction (HOI) implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 36-28, *Awards Program*, and Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 36-2806, *Military Awards Criteria and Procedures*. It sets forth the procedures for processing Medal of Honor (MOH) nominations to the Office of the Secretary of Defense. This instruction requires the collection and or maintenance of information protected by the Privacy Act of 1974 authorized by Department of Defense Instruction 5400.11, *DoD Privacy and Civil Liberties Programs*. The applicable System of Record Notice (SORN) F036 AFPC V, Awards and Decorations is available at: **https://dpcld.defense.gov/Privacy/SORNs/**. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the office of primary responsibility using DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document is substantially revised and must be completely reviewed. It updates office symbols throughout the publication.

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Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1. Medal of Honor (MOH) History. The Medal of Honor is the United States military's highest and most prestigious decoration, awarded by the President of the United States (POTUS) in the name of Congress. It was first established for the Navy on 9 December 1861, with President Abraham Lincoln signing the bill into law on 21 December 1861. A similar bill was introduced for the Army by Senator Henry Wilson on 17 February 1862, and signed into law by President Lincoln on 12 July 1862, officially creating the Army's MOH. While initially intended for enlisted personnel demonstrating exceptional valor, Congress extended eligibility to Army officers in 1863. In July 1960, Congress authorized the MOH specifically for the Department of the Air Force (DAF), drawing on the existing legislation for the Army medal and codified under Title 10 United States Code (USC) Section (§) 9271, *Medal of honor: award*. Throughout its history, the MOH has maintained its unparalleled status, recognizing the rarest and most extraordinary acts of bravery in American military history. Its rigorous criteria, established by Congress, ensure that only the most valid, courageous, and heroic acts are recognized.

1.2. Description of the Medal, Accessories, and Appurtenances.

1.2.1. MOH Medal Set.

1.2.1.1. The Medal of Honor is a gold, five-pointed star with a point facing down, each point tipped with trefoils and featuring a laurel and oak crown on a green background. At the star's center, a ring of 34 stars surrounds a representation of the Statue of Liberty's head. The star hangs from a bar inscribed with "VALOR" above a stylized thunderbolt, derived from the DAF coat of arms. The thunderbolt is composed of a baton with eagle claws resting on aviator's wings emitting thunderbolts.

1.2.1.2. The medal's reverse is blank, allowing for engraving. It is suspended from a light-blue moiré silk neckband, 1-3/16 inches wide and 21-3/4 inches long, attached behind a square pad of ribbon. The ribbon bar displays 13 white stars in a triple chevron pattern (two chevrons of five stars and one of three). A hexagonal rosette of light-blue ribbon (½ inch in diameter) with a white star insert is included for civilian wear.

1.2.1.3. The DAF design of the MOH is awarded to recipients honored on or after 1 November 1965. Pre-1965 replacements will be of the original design. Due to federal statutes, it should not be referred to as the "Department of the Air Force MOH", but rather as "Medal of Honor—Department of the Air Force design" or "the Department of the Air Force designed MOH".

1.2.1.4. All MOHs are engraved with the recipient's name and supplied by the Air Force Personnel Center, Promotions, Evaluations and Recognitions Policy Branch (AFPC/DPPSP).

1.2.2. MOH Flag.

1.2.2.1. Public Law 107-248, enacted on 23 October 2002, mandated the creation of a MOH flag to be presented to each MOH recipient awarded the medal after that date. To select a design, a panel of representatives from each Service (Army, Marine Corps, Navy, Air Force, and Coast Guard), the Office of the Secretary of Defense, a historian, and the

MOH Society reviewed submissions and recommended a design to the Principal Deputy to the Under Secretary of Defense for Personnel and Readiness. On 15 December 2004, the design submitted by Sarah LeClerc, an illustrator at the Institute of Heraldry, was approved.

1.2.2.2. The MOH flag, an appurtenance of the MOH, commemorates the sacrifices made for our freedoms and emphasizes the MOH's status as the highest award for valor in the U.S. Armed Forces. The flag is light blue with a gold fringe and features thirteen white stars arranged in the same configuration as on the octagonal "pad" from which the MOH is suspended.

1.2.3. MOH Display Cases. Two types of display cases are available: one for the medal set and one for the flag (see **Figure 1.1**.).

Figure 1.1. MOH Display Cases—Medal Set and Flag.



1.2.3.1. MOH Medal Set Display Case. This case is reserved for posthumous MOH awards only, as living recipients wear the medal. The case contains the medal, ribbon bar, and lapel pin mounted in a 13 ¼" x 10 ¾" x 2" cherry wood case with a glass front and navy blue velvet background.

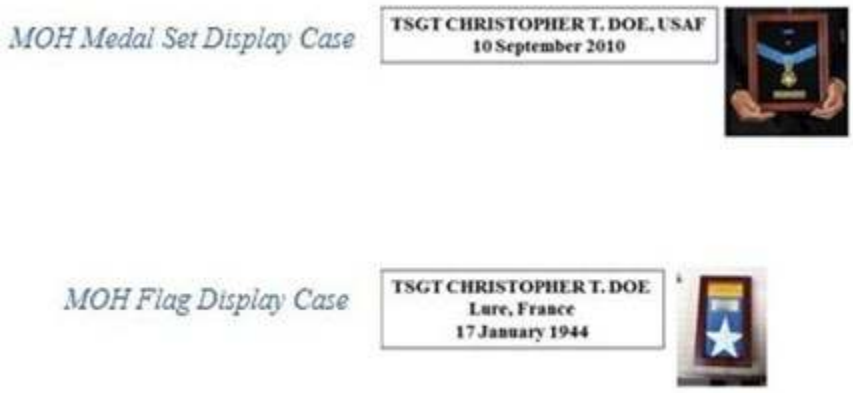
1.2.3.2. MOH Flag Display Case. This case is for living recipients or the Primary Next of Kin (PNOK) of members who died after 23 October 2002. The case contains the flag mounted in a hinged, 6" wide x 11" high x 1 ½" cherry wood case with a glass front and dark blue interior.

1.2.3.3. Brass Plates. A brass plate will be affixed to the display cases. The inscription (engrave) on the brass plates will be as follows (refer to **Figure 1.2**.):

1.2.3.3.1. MOH Medal Set Display Case. Grade (acronym), name (first, middle initial, last), branch of service (e.g., USAF, USSF), and the date of the White House Presentation ceremony.

1.2.3.3.2. MOH Flag Display Case. Grade (acronym), name (first, middle initial, last), location of action, and the date of action.

Figure 1.2. Inscription on Brass Plates.



1.3. Courtesies and Privileges Accorded to MOH Recipients. Refer to DAFMAN 36-2806.

1.4. Replacement and Duplicate MOH. In accordance with Title 10 USC § 9284, *Medal of honor: duplicate medal,* recipients may submit a written request for a replacement Medal of Honor and flag. Additionally, under Title 10 USC § 9277, *Medal of honor; Air Force cross; distinguished-service cross; distinguished-service medal; silver star: replacement*, DAF will replace—at no cost—any MOH, bar, ribbon, rosette, or associated device that is stolen, lost, destroyed, or rendered unfit for use, provided the loss was not due to the fault or neglect of the recipient. Refer to DAFMAN 36-2806 for detailed guidance.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. Director of Administration and Management to the Secretary of the Air Force (SAF/AA). Provides financial support for the planning and execution of the MOH ceremonies.

2.2. Secretary of the Air Force Office of Public Affairs (SAF/PA). Provides communication, graphics, public engagement, and media support for the MOH ceremonies.

2.3. Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Force Management Integration (SAF/MRM). Serves as initial liaison to the White House Military Office (WHMO).

2.4. Department of the Air Force Protocol (SAF/DSP). Assists the Project Officer in planning and executing the MOH ceremonies.

2.5. Director of Air Force Military Force Management (AF/A1P). Assists with processing MOH nominations for USAF recipients and provides expert advice on MOH ceremony planning.

2.6. Director of Space Force Military Force Management Policy (SF/S1P). Assists with processing MOH nominations for USSF recipients and provides expert advice on planning MOH ceremonies.

2.7. Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board. Reviews all MOH submissions and provides recommendations to the Secretary of the Air Force.

2.8. Project Officer. Serves as the lead for all aspects of planning and executing ceremonies honoring a Medal of Honor recipient.

2.9. Chief of Chaplains (AF/HC). Delivers the invocation and benediction at MOH ceremonies held at the White House, Hall of Heroes, and Air Force Memorial.

Chapter 3

MEDAL OF HONOR NOMINATION

3.1. Eligibility Requirements. This HOI does not supersede or take precedence over Department of Defense Manual (DoDM) 1348.33, Volume 1, *Manual of Military Decorations and Awards: Medal of Honor*, or DAFMAN 36-2806.

3.1.1. According to Title 10 USC § 9271, the MOH may be awarded to members of the Air Force or the Space Force who distinguish themselves conspicuously by gallantry and intrepidity at the risk of their lives above and beyond the call of duty under any of the following circumstances:

3.1.1.1. While engaged in an action against an enemy of the United States;

3.1.1.2. While engaged in military operations involving conflict with an opposing foreign force; or

3.1.1.3. While serving with friendly foreign forces engaged in an armed conflict against an opposing armed force in which the U.S. is not a belligerent party.

3.1.2. The deed performed must have been one of personal bravery or self-sacrifice so conspicuous as to clearly distinguish the individual above his comrades and must have involved risk of life. While the MOH criteria include a requirement for the service member to risk his or her life, there is no requirement for the member to be wounded or killed in order to meet the "risk of life" portion of the MOH eligibility criteria.

3.1.3. Proof beyond a reasonable doubt that the service member performed the valorous action for which the member was recommended for the MOH.

3.2. Nominations. All MOH nominations must be formally entered into official channels within three years of the act of valor, and awarded within five years. Until the awarding authority announces the final decision, MOH nominations should be marked and handled as Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI). Premature disclosure is prohibited. To ensure timely processing, the following guidelines are in place:

3.2.1. Nominations should be initiated within 45 days of the valorous action and processed expeditiously (within ten days of receipt) at each command level in the review process. Nominations must reach the Secretary of the Air Force (SecAF) within 12 months of award initiation.

3.2.2. The first colonel/O-6 commander in the chain of command is responsible for sending advance notification to the Director of Personnel at the relevant Air or Space Component Command, as well as to AFPC/DPPSP (**afpc.dppsp.workflow@us.af.mil**). This notification is critical to enable timely assistance and guidance from these organizations.

3.3. Processing Procedures. This section outlines the procedures for processing MOH recommendations.

3.3.1. Review Process by the Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board.

3.3.1.1. The Decorations Board, a component of the Secretary of the Air Force Personnel Council (SAFPC) operating under DAFI 36-2023 and delegated authority by SAF/MR under Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive (HAFMD) 1-24, *Assistant Secretary of the the Air Force (Manpower and Reserve Affairs)*, conducts a comprehensive review of all MOH recommendations in a plenary session.

3.3.1.2. Following its review, the board's recommendation (approval, disapproval, or downgrade) is forwarded through the chain of command, including Headquarters Air Force (HAF), the Office of the Secretary of the Air Force, and Department of War (DoW) reviewing authorities, culminating in a final decision by the President of the United States (POTUS) (**Table 3.1**).

3.3.2. Required Documents for MOH Nominations. MOH nominations must be complete and legible, adhering to DAFMAN 36-2806, and include the following: DAF Form 3994, narrative justification, endorsement from the commander of the applicable Air or Space Component Command, chain of command endorsement, proposed unclassified citation, at least two eyewitness statements, the member’s performance report or biography, and a list of involved personnel with their awards (grade, full name, recommended/approved decoration). Terrain maps are recommended to aid in the nomination process. Incomplete or illegible submissions will be returned. See Figures **3.1** and **3.2** for the HAF routing process.

3.3.3. Responsibilities of the Decorations Board Recorder. The Decorations Board Recorder is responsible for the following: scheduling board meetings, compiling and distributing pre-meeting read-ahead packets (containing the recommendation, relevant legislation, and evaluation criteria) to board members at least two weeks prior to the meeting, and providing vote sheets on the meeting day.

Figure 3.1. MOH Nomination Staffing Process.

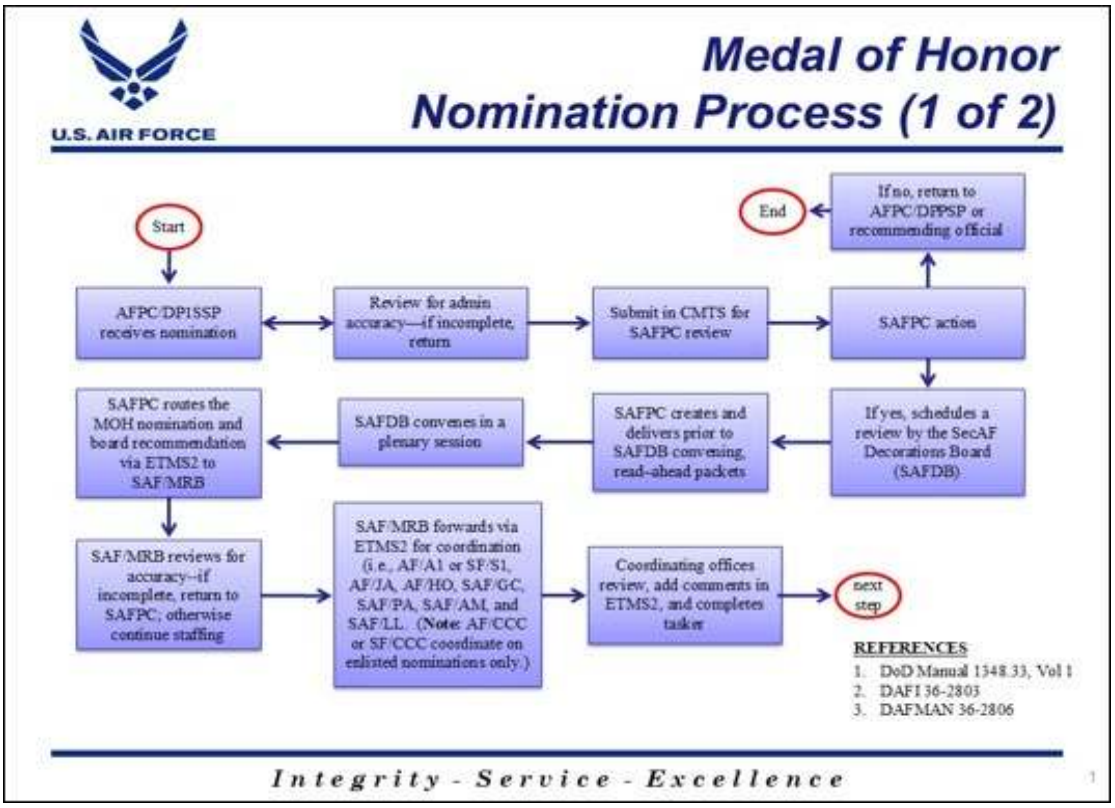
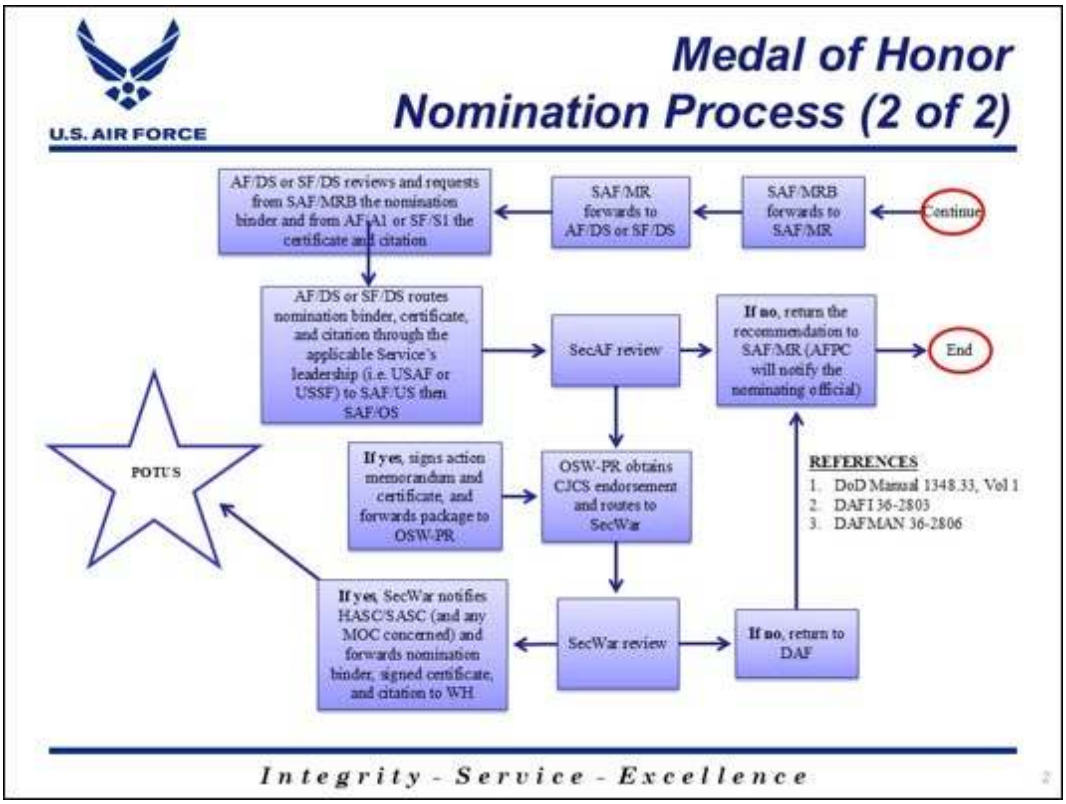


Figure 3.2. MOH Nomination Staffing Process (cont).



3.3.4. Submitting Recommendations via Enterprise Task Management Software Solution (ETMS2). Following the Decorations Board's review, the following steps are required for Headquarters Air Force (HAF) processing through ETMS2:

3.3.4.1. ETMS2 Submission Preparation. The board recorder prepares the ETMS2 submission, ensuring it includes the following (with scanned copies of all signed documents): a Staff Summary Sheet (Figures **3.3 and 3.4**.), SecAF Action Memo, endorsement memos, DÉCOR 6, MOH criteria/legislation, event synopsis, justification, maps/photos, DAF Form 1168, *Statement of Suspect/Witness/Complainant*, biographical information (**Attachment 4**), acronym list, and a processing timeline.

3.3.4.2. Coordination and Routing within ETMS2. The ETMS2 action must be marked "private" and tasked to SAF/MR for coordination with the following offices prior to SecAF routing: AF/A1 or SF/S1, Judge Advocate General, AF/HO, CMSAF (for USAF enlisted), CMSSF (for USSF enlisted), SAF/LL, and the General Counsel.

3.3.4.3. AF/A1P or SF/S1P Responsibilities (Upon Board Recommendation for Approval). If the Decorations Board recommends approval, AF/A1P or SF/S1P will:

3.3.4.3.1. Upload an endorsement memorandum for the CSAF or CSO signature to ETMS2.

3.3.4.3.2. Coordinate with SAF/PA for the printing of a MOH certificate.

3.3.4.4. Director of Staff Notification and Binder Preparation. Upon notification from AF/DS or SF/DS, the board recorder provides them with the MOH nomination binder suitable for the Secretary of War (SecWar) and POTUS. AF/A1 or SF/S1 provides AF/DS or SF/DS the MOH certificate and citation in a presentation folder.

Figure 3.3. Sample Staff Summary Sheet.

----------[2-LTR or L2] COORD
AF/A1 Coord – [coordinates on USAF nominations only]
SF/S1 Coord – [coordinates on USSF nominations only]
AF/HO Info –
SAF/AM Info –
SAF/PA Info –
SAF/LL Info –
AF/JA Coord –
SAF/GC Coord –
SAF/MR Coord –
----------STAFF SUMMARY
AO: [rank] [name], [organization], [telephone number]
SSS Date:
SUSPENSE:
OUTSIDE AGENCY SUSPENSE:

SUBJECT: **CUI** - Medal of Honor (MOH) Nomination—[rank and full name of nominee]

1. PURPOSE: To obtain SecAF signature on the memorandum (Tab 2) and the certificate (blue folder), and [CSAF or CSO] signature on the memorandum (Tab 4), recommending approval of the MOH nomination for [rank and full name of nominee].

2. BACKGROUND: The MOH, our Nation's highest military honor, recognizes service members who demonstrate extraordinary gallantry and intrepidity, risking their lives above and beyond the call of duty in action against a U.S. enemy, during military operations involving conflict with opposing foreign forces, or while serving with friendly forces engaged in armed conflict where the U.S. is not a combatant. Consideration for the MOH requires irrefutable proof of the valorous action. Please see Tab 5 for specific criteria and applicable legislation.

3. DISCUSSION: On [date], [senior recommending official] recommended [rank and last name of nominee] for the Medal of Honor, recognizing [his/her] gallantry and intrepidity above and beyond the call of duty while engaged with an armed enemy in [location] on [date of action] (Tabs 6-8). [Summary of action].

Supporting documentation, including maps, diagrams, photographs, witness statements, storyboard, Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board results, biography, and Personnel Records Brief, is enclosed (Tab 9).

This nomination is being submitted as a hardcopy binder (Office of the Secretary of War format) and should be handled as **CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION**. Per Department of War policy, no public comments may be made regarding this Medal of Honor case until the award is either presented or officially announced by the White House.

4. EXSUM OF TABS:

TAB 1: A placeholder for SecWar's memorandum supporting the nomination.

TAB 2: SecAF's memorandum supporting the nomination.

TAB 3: A placeholder for the Chairman, Joint Chiefs of Staff memorandum supporting the nomination.

Figure 3.4. Sample Staff Summary Sheet (continuation).

TAB 4: [CSAF or CSO] memorandum supporting the nomination.
TAB 5: A copy of the applicable MOH criteria and legislation.
TAB 6: [senior recommending official] memorandum supporting the nomination.
TAB 7: A placeholder for SecWar's Congressional Notification Letters.
TAB 8: A copy of the narrative justification for the MOH nomination.
TAB 9: A copy of documents to support the MOH nomination.
TAB 10: 1 timeline of the routing process and a listing of acronyms used in the nomination package.

5. VIEWS OF OTHERS: The Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board reviewed the nomination on [date] and recommends approval. The OSD required timeline and acronym brief are provided (Tab 10).

6. LATE JUSTIFICATION: [If applicable. Keep it short, no more than 4 sentences.]

7. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION: [If applicable; identify any important information not previously discussed.]

8. RECOMMENDATION: SecAF sign the memo (Tab 2) and certificate in blue folder; and [CSAF or CSO] sign the memo (Tab 4).

//signed, initials, date// (Must be approved/signed by 2-LTR/L2 principal or deputy)
Signature Block

Tabs (list all tabs that are in the Final Docs Library)
1. SecWar Memo (placeholder) (Must match electronic file name)
2. SecAF Memo (Must match electronic file name)
3. CJCS Memo (placeholder) (Must match electronic file name)
4. (CSAF or CSO) Memo (Must match electronic file name)
5. Award Criteria and Legislation (Must match electronic file name)
6. (senior recommending official) Memo (Must match electronic file name)
7. Congressional Notification Letters [SecWar signs] (Must match electronic file name)
8. Narrative Justification (Must match electronic file name)
9. Supporting Documents (Must match electronic file name)
10. Timeline and Acronym Brief (Must match electronic file name)

----------COORD

SAF/DSE	Coord –
SF/CCC	Info – [coordinates on USSF enlisted nominations only]
AF/CCC	Info – [coordinates on USAF nominations only]
SF/DS	Coord – [coordinates on USSF nominations only]
AF/DS	Coord – [coordinates on USAF nominations only]
SF/VCSO	Coord – [coordinates on USSF nominations only]
AF/CV	Coord – [coordinates on USAF nominations only]
SF/CSO	Info – [coordinates on USSF nominations only]
AF/CC	Coord – [coordinates on USAF nominations only]
SAF/DS	Coord –
SAF/US	Coord –
SAF/OS	Sign –

3.3.5. MOH Nomination Requirements. A sample nomination binder is available at: **https://prhome.war.gov/M-RA/Inside-M-RA/MPP/OEPM/**. MOH nominations must meet the following minimum requirements:

3.3.5.1. General Requirements:

3.3.5.1.1. Two Copies. Submit two copies of the nomination, excluding the official citation and certificate.

3.3.5.1.2. Organized Binder. Use a three-ring binder with a table of contents.

3.3.5.1.3. Legible Supporting Documents. Include clear supporting documents (forms, narratives, witness statements, storyboards, visuals); use original color documents whenever possible and transcribe illegible documents.

3.3.5.1.4. Electronic and Physical Submission. Provide both electronic and physical copies of the nomination. Exclude all classified, sensitive, or special category information from the electronic copy. Submit any classified information separately as hard copies.

3.3.5.1.5. Presentation Folder. The citation and certificate must be submitted in a presentation folder suitable for POTUS presentation (obtainable from AFPC/DPPSP).

3.3.5.2. Requirements for Late Nominations (Title 10 USC § 1130):

3.3.5.2.1. MOH Timeline. Provide a detailed timeline of the MOH processing.

3.3.5.2.2. Congressional Request Letters. Provide copies of the original request letters from the Member of Congress.

Table 3.1. MOH Approval and Disapproval Authority.

AUTHORIT	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE	DOWNGRADE
POTUS	Yes	Yes	Yes
SECWAR	No	Yes	No
SECAF	No	Yes	Yes

3.3.6. After SecAF signature on the certificate and action memo, the nomination binder is hand-delivered to ODASW(MPP)/OEPM. Congressional notification occurs after SecWar concurrence.

3.3.7. Following Presidential approval, the board recorder closes the task in ETMS2 and requests special orders from AFPC/DPPSP (the term “posthumous” should appear *only* on the citation and special orders).

3.3.8. AFPC/DPPSP handles distribution of unclassified documents per DAFMAN 36-2806, while the Secretary of the Air Force Decorations Board handles classified documents. Both offices will digitize all records in accordance with AFI 33-322, paragraph 4.3.1.

Chapter 4

MEDAL OF HONOR PRESENTATION

4.1. MOH Presentation. When practical, presentation of the MOH shall be made by POTUS, as the Commander in Chief, in a formal ceremony in Washington, DC. As such, premature public disclosure of information concerning recommendations, processing, and approval or disapproval actions is a potential source of embarrassment to those recommended and the Government. Additionally, in the case of approved recommendations, it could diminish the impact of ceremonies at which the presentation is made. Therefore, to prevent premature disclosure, DoW policy is not to comment on any MOH case under consideration. Accordingly, the processing of MOH recommendations shall be handled as CUI until the awards are announced officially or are presented. Additionally, pending MOH recommendations are pre-decisional and are exempt from release to the public.

4.2. MOH Flag Presentation. The MOH flag shall be presented to each MOH recipient who was living as of 23 October 2002. If the MOH recipient has passed away since 23 October 2002, the MOH flag shall be presented to the PNOK.

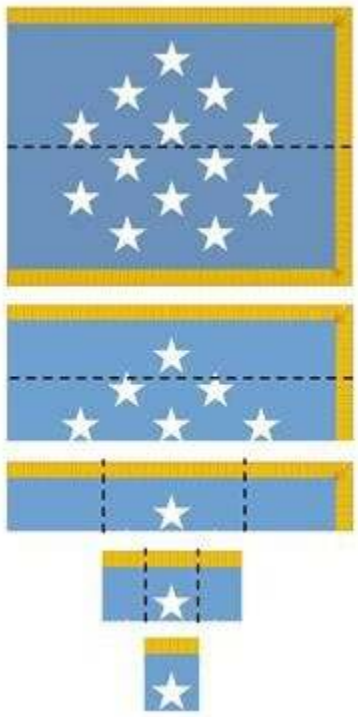
4.2.1. At a minimum, a currently serving general or flag officer will preside over the ceremony. The MOH flag shall not be mailed to the recipient or PNOK.

4.2.2. Only one MOH flag shall be presented to the MOH recipient or PNOK. The MOH flag shall be folded with one star showing, representing the MOH and presented during the ceremony.

4.2.3. MOH flags shall be folded in accordance with current procedures in front of the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier at Arlington National Cemetery, Arlington, Virginia, by the DAF Honor Guard. This guidance is not mandated by laws or statues; rather, it reflects verbal direction provided through DoW leadership channels via the White House. The folding will be recorded and incorporated into a tribute video.

4.2.4. Refer to **Figure 4.1** for a folding diagram. Fold the flag in half twice width wise. Fold the flag in thirds length wise, leaving one star showing. Fold the flag in thirds so that one star is centered. The folded flag should form a rectangle with one star showing representing the recipients MOH.

Figure 4.1. Folding of the MOH Flag.



4.3. Display of the MOH Flag.

4.3.1. The MOH flag is a ceremonial flag for indoor use and is considered a personal flag which recipients may display in their home or office.

4.3.2. The MOH flag may be displayed publicly when the individual is in attendance on the reviewing stand in an official ceremony. If the MOH flag is displayed on a flagstaff, the flagstaff shall be eight feet tall, but shall not be higher than the U.S. flag if displayed at the same time as the U.S. flag.

4.3.3. When the MOH flag is displayed with the U.S. flag, the U.S. flag shall hold the position of superior prominence and in the position of honor on the right. The MOH flag shall be placed to the left of the U.S. flag. When viewed from an audience the U.S. flag shall be on the left and the MOH flag shall be on the right. Order of precedence of the MOH flag when displayed with state, organizational, and/or general or flag officer personal flags are: U.S. flag, state flag, organizational flag, personal flag, and then MOH flag.

4.3.4. The procedures for Government agencies or civilian institutions to request a MOH flag is provided in DAFMAN 36-2806. As an appurtenance to the MOH, the MOH flag shall be displayed in an attractive, dignified, and secure manner.

4.4. Ceremonies . MOH ceremonies typically involve three events over three consecutive days, commencing approximately 60 days after the White House publicly announces the award approval. The first day features the POTUS presentation of the MOH to the recipient or PNOK at the White House. The second day includes an induction ceremony at the Pentagon's Hall of Heroes. Finally, the third day consists of an unveiling ceremony at the Air Force Memorial, with a wreath-laying

for posthumous awards. All planning and related activities are treated as CUI until the public announcement of the award. Procedures for organizing these ceremonies follow.

4.4.1. POTUS Intent to Approve. Upon White House notification of POTUS intent to approve a MOH, SAF/MRM takes the following actions:

4.4.1.1. Protected Security Status. If the nominee holds a protected security status position, request the office of the Under Secretary of War (Personnel and Readiness) to coordinate with the White House for strict confidentiality ("close hold") and a private award ceremony.

4.4.1.2. Notify DAF Leadership. Send a "CLOSE HOLD" email to the following leaders:

4.4.1.2.1. USAF: CSAF with a courtesy copy to the Vice Chief of Staff of the Air Force, AF/DS, AF/CMSAF, SAF/MR, SAF/AA, SAF/PA, and AF/A1.

4.4.1.2.2. USSF: CSO with a courtesy copy to the Vice Chief of Staff of Space Operations, SF/DS, SF/CMSSF, SAF/MR, SAF/AA, SAF/PA, and SF/S1.

4.4.1.3. Designate Ceremony Lead. Email AF/DS or SF/DS to request selection of a HAF 2-letter organization to lead ceremony planning. This organization will assign a Project Officer (typically a colonel/O-6) who will serve as the primary point of contact for planning and execution. The Project Officer's responsibilities include:

4.4.1.3.1. Attend the WHMO-scheduled event overview meeting at the White House.

4.4.1.3.2. Develop a transportation plan for the week of ceremonies, including:

4.4.1.3.2.1. Coordinate with the nearest military installation to provide local support to the MOH recipient or PNOK, immediate family, and the assigned escort. This support includes transportation to/from residence, airport, and hotel for MOH ceremonies.

4.4.1.3.2.2. Coordinate motorcade escorts with the Pentagon Force Protection Agency.

4.4.1.3.3. Solicits volunteer escorts for:

4.4.1.3.3.1. One escort for the recipient or PNOK, who will serve as the Paying Agent.

4.4.1.3.3.1.1. Escort will remain with recipient or PNOK throughout the ceremony week.

4.4.1.3.3.1.2. In cases where the recipient or PNOK will be flying to the National Capital Region (NCR), the escort will travel to recipients or PNOK's departing airport, receive a hand-off from the installation representative, and escort the recipient or PNOK to the NCR. On the return trip, the escort will accompany the recipient or PNOK and hand-off back to the installation representative.

4.4.1.3.3.1.3. Ensure recipient's military uniform for the ceremonies is in accordance with DAFI 36-2903, *Dress and Personal Appearance of Department of the Air Force Personnel*, and replaces items as needed. This paragraph constitutes fiscal authority to spend appropriated funds to replace

uniform items as needed by the recipient.

4.4.1.3.3.2. Bus escort (1 each) for the White House Presentation ceremony.

4.4.1.3.3.3. Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies.

4.4.1.3.4. Provides weekly updates to the applicable Director of Staff (AF/DS or SF/DS) and daily updates during week of ceremonies.

4.4.1.3.5. Develops ceremony guidance for senior DAF leaders, MOH recipient or PNOK, and immediate family (refer to **Attachment 2**).

4.4.1.3.6. Obtains photographs from recipient or PNOK and unit, and provides photographs to SAF/PA for media purposes (e.g., posters, programs, and social media).

4.4.1.4. Assist WHMO with pre-ceremony work (e.g. providing information on recipient and validating data) until a Project Officer is appointed.

4.4.1.5. Attend a WHMO scheduled event overview meeting (if scheduled prior to appointment of a Project Officer).

4.4.1.6. Provide the contact information for the assigned Project Officer to WHMO.

4.4.1.7. Provide the final White House approved MOH citation to AF/A1 or SF/S1 for printing, AF/DS or SF/DS for the speechwriters, and the Project Officer.

4.4.1.8. Obtains copy of signed MOH certificate from WHMO and provides to AF/A1 or SF/S1 for records distribution (refer to **paragraph 3.3.8**.).

4.4.2. Ceremony Pre-Planning. Upon appointment, the Project Officer will (also refer to **Attachment 5**):

4.4.2.1. Meet with SAF/DSP and SAF/AA (Budget) representative to discuss the path forward for the ceremonies.

4.4.2.2. Request SAF/AA authorize government-issued cell phones for the Project Officer and Assistant Project Officers for the ceremony duration. The purpose of these cell phones is to enable immediate access to email and facilitate prompt communication with the recipient (or PNOK) and their immediate family while the Project Officers are away from their regular work station.

4.4.2.3. Requests two volunteers to serve as Assistant Project Officers to assist with the planning of the ceremonies.

4.4.2.4. Set-up an initial meeting with all stakeholders, collectively known as the "Planning and Execution Team." This team includes representatives from the following offices: SAF/MR, AF/A1 or SF/S1, SAF/DSP, SAF/PA, AF/HO, SAF/AA, SAF/LL, and AFDW, in addition to the Assistant Project Officers. The team's responsibilities encompass planning the Hall of Heroes Induction and the Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies, as well as coordinating transportation to and from the White House presentation ceremony. Attendance at these meetings is mandatory, and a substitute representative must be designated if the primary attendee is unable to participate.

4.4.2.4.1. SAF/DSP.

4.4.2.4.1.1. Identifies host for DAF sponsored ceremonies—Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling, and sets tentative dates for the ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.1.2. Coordinates office calls with the host(s) of the DAF ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.1.3. Coordinates lunch location, invitations, menu, reception, and seating.

4.4.2.4.1.4. Develops script and sequence of events for the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air F Memorial Unveiling ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.1.5. Coordinates with Air Force District of Washington Ceremonies (AFDW/CCP) for the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies--setup, proffer, flags, ceremony music, and ushers.

4.4.2.4.1.6. Determines uniform for all ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.1.7. Requests AFDW/CCP assistance with obtaining transportation for the events.

4.4.2.4.1.8. Develops event books and briefs for SecAF and applicable Service Chief (CSAF or CSO), or host (if not SecAF and CSAF or CSO).

4.4.2.4.1.9. Determines "A" list for all ceremonies—White House Presentation, Hall of Heroes Induction, and Air Force Memorial Unveiling.

4.4.2.4.1.10. Obtains wheelchairs (if needed) for all ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.1.11. Schedules Pentagon tour for recipient or PNOK and immediate family.

4.4.2.4.1.12. Coordinates photographer for all ceremonies—White House Presentation, Hall of Heroes Induction, and Air Force Memorial Unveiling.

4.4.2.4.2. SAF/AA.

4.4.2.4.2.1. Provides funding for Project Officer's TDY to brief the recipient or PNOK on MOH entitlements (refer to Attachments **7** and **8**), the sequence of events, etc.

4.4.2.4.2.2. Determines and contracts a hotel.

4.4.2.4.2.3. Arranges travel through the Defense Travel System (DTS) for recipient or the PNOK and immediate family (refer to Terms in **Attachment 1**), which includes transportation and hotel reservations.

4.4.2.4.2.4. Obtains funds for Paying Agent and coordinates training for the agent.

4.4.2.4.2.5. Participates in DAF's ceremony planning meetings.

4.4.2.4.3. SAF/PA.

4.4.2.4.3.1. Prints the MOH certificate for SecAF and POTUS signature.

4.4.2.4.3.2. Participates in DAF's ceremony planning meetings, providing public affairs guidance.

4.4.2.4.3.3. Prepares press package.

4.4.2.4.3.4. Updates official DAF social media and MOH website.

4.4.2.4.3.5. Coordinates Pentagon entry and placement of Press for Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.3.6. Coordinates public affairs coverage for the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies.

4.4.2.4.3.7. Prepares and obtains programs and posters for the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies, and the receptions.

4.4.2.4.3.8. Obtains from the Project Officer photographs of the recipient and selects photographs to be used for media purposes.

4.4.2.4.3.9. Notifies home station Public Affairs Officer(s).

4.4.2.4.3.10. Coordinates with the DoW graphics office for the Hall of Heroes presentation items—a replica of the Hall of Heroes board and a framed photograph and citation for the unveiling.

4.4.2.4.3.11. Prepares a tribute video consisting of the three ceremonies and folding of the MOH flag.

4.4.3. After POTUS Notification. Following POTUS notification to the recipient or PNOK regarding the MOH approval, the Project Officer will:

4.4.3.1. Request TDY funding from SAF/AA to brief the recipient or PNOK on MOH benefits, media protocols, and the ceremony schedule.

4.4.3.2. Contact the recipient or PNOK to:

4.4.3.2.1. Schedule the briefing.

4.4.3.2.2. Advise them to identify 100 family/friends for ceremony invitations (travel for non-immediate family/friends will not be at government expense).

4.4.3.2.3. Obtain pictures of recipient (childhood through military career).

4.4.3.2.4. Collect immediate family information (full name, social security number, date of birth, address, telephone number, and email address) to create DTS profiles. **Note:** Immediate family is defined as surviving spouse, children (natural and adopted), and mother and father or person(s) granted legal custody of the person by a court decree or statutory provision. Siblings will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

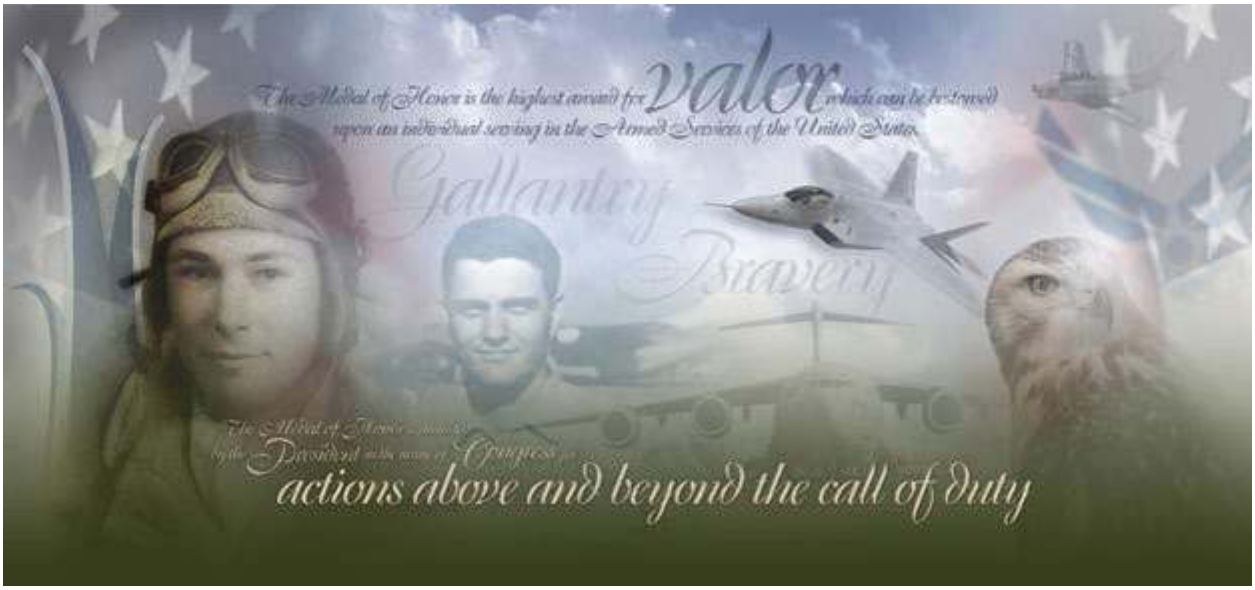
4.4.4. Presentation Date. Once the White House confirms the presentation date, the Project Officer will:

4.4.4.1. Brief the Director of Staff (AF/DS or SF/DS) regarding the details of all three ceremonies: the White House Presentation, the Hall of Heroes Induction, and the Air Force Memorial Unveiling. The briefing should be conducted with the assistance of the Director's protocol office.

4.4.4.2. Reserve the Pentagon Auditorium (703-692-0775 or at https://pntauditsched.army.mil) for a total of three days for the Hall of Heroes Induction ceremony. Day one will be for setup, day two is for the ceremony, and day three is for takedown. It is necessary to hold the ceremony in the Auditorium to accommodate the larger number of expected attendees. (The Hall of Heroes has a capacity of only 100 people, whereas the Pentagon Auditorium seats 344.) Accessing the reservation website requires a DoW Common Access Card. If the desired dates are unavailable, contact the agency or office currently holding the reservation and request that they relinquish it. The Pentagon Auditorium customer service desk can aid with this process.

4.4.4.3. Schedule a meeting with the Live Events Production Manager in the Pentagon Auditorium (room MG652) to discuss contracts for setup, lighting, permits, and other event requirements. The Air Force Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony backdrop (**Figure 4.2**) will need to be retrieved from the Pentagon Auditorium warehouse.

Figure 4.2. Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony Backdrop (Sample).



4.4.4.4. Schedule a Planning and Execution Team meeting to begin planning – funding, DTS, movement plan, transportation, hotel, reception, display posters, media, invite list, media coverage, tribute video, etc. The following actions must be accomplished.

4.4.4.4.1. Requests Pentagon Force Protection Agency provide security screening, Pentagon access, and motorcade escorts.

4.4.4.4.2. Requests AFDW/CCP assistance with obtaining transportation from AFDW.

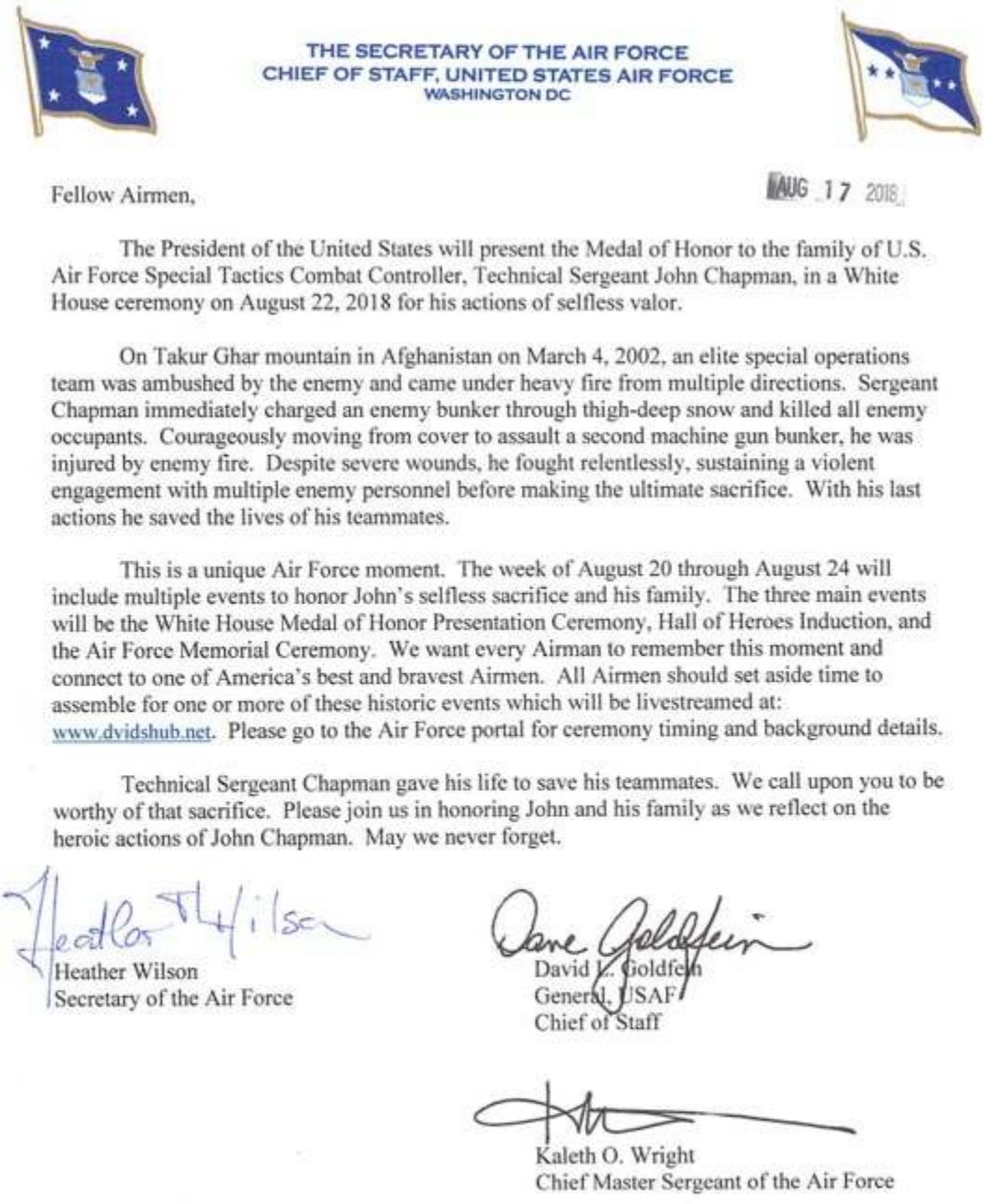
4.4.4.4.3. Contact AF/HC to schedule invocation and benediction for the ceremonies—White House Presentation, Hall of Heroes Induction, and Air Force Memorial Unveiling.

4.4.4.4.4. Collaborate with SAF/AA to obtain SecAF approval of the use of Emergency and Extraordinary Expense funds for transportation to events, and if

applicable the purchase of a military uniform (to include uniform items) for the living MOH recipient.

4.4.4.5. Draft and staff an announcement letter. Immediately after the White House publicly announces POTUS decision to approve the award, a letter should be released (refer to **Figure 4.3**.).

Figure 4.3. Sample Announcement Letter.



THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE
CHIEF OF STAFF, UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
WASHINGTON DC

Fellow Airmen,

AUG 17 2018

The President of the United States will present the Medal of Honor to the family of U.S. Air Force Special Tactics Combat Controller, Technical Sergeant John Chapman, in a White House ceremony on August 22, 2018 for his actions of selfless valor.

On Takur Ghar mountain in Afghanistan on March 4, 2002, an elite special operations team was ambushed by the enemy and came under heavy fire from multiple directions. Sergeant Chapman immediately charged an enemy bunker through thigh-deep snow and killed all enemy occupants. Courageously moving from cover to assault a second machine gun bunker, he was injured by enemy fire. Despite severe wounds, he fought relentlessly, sustaining a violent engagement with multiple enemy personnel before making the ultimate sacrifice. With his last actions he saved the lives of his teammates.

This is a unique Air Force moment. The week of August 20 through August 24 will include multiple events to honor John's selfless sacrifice and his family. The three main events will be the White House Medal of Honor Presentation Ceremony, Hall of Heroes Induction, and the Air Force Memorial Ceremony. We want every Airman to remember this moment and connect to one of America's best and bravest Airmen. All Airmen should set aside time to assemble for one or more of these historic events which will be livestreamed at: www.dvidshub.net. Please go to the Air Force portal for ceremony timing and background details.

Technical Sergeant Chapman gave his life to save his teammates. We call upon you to be worthy of that sacrifice. Please join us in honoring John and his family as we reflect on the heroic actions of John Chapman. May we never forget.

Heather Wilson
Secretary of the Air Force

David L. Goldfein
General, USAF
Chief of Staff

Kaleth O. Wright
Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force

4.4.5. Sequence of White House Presentation Ceremony. The sequence may vary.

4.4.5.1. POTUS announced into East Room and HONORS.

4.4.5.2. POTUS joins AF/HC on stage.

4.4.5.3. AF/HC delivers invocation.

4.4.5.4. POTUS delivers remarks.

4.4.5.5. Recipient or PNOK joins POTUS on stage after remarks.

4.4.5.6. POTUS asks the White House Military Aide to read citation.

4.4.5.7. Citation read, medal presented, and photos are taken.

4.4.5.8. AF/HC delivers benediction.

4.4.5.9. POTUS departs.

4.4.5.10. Guests move to State Dining Room for the reception (anticipate 60 min).

4.4.6. Sequence of Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony. The sequence may vary.

4.4.6.1. Recipient or PNOK and immediate family arrives at Pentagon/Mall Entrance.

4.4.6.1.1. Project Officer takes recipient or PNOK to Pentagon Auditorium for Hall of Heroes Induction ceremony rehearsal.

4.4.6.1.2. Assistant Project Officer takes immediate family on a VIP Pentagon Tour.

4.4.6.2. Recipient or PNOK and immediate family have lunch with SecAF and the applicable Service Chief (CSAF or CSO). [CMSAF or CMSSF is present for enlisted recipients.].

4.4.6.2.1. Guests arrive for VIP Pentagon Tour.

4.4.6.3. Office Call with SecWar. Attended by SecAF, the applicable Service Chief (CSAF or CSO), recipient or PNOK, and immediate family. [CMSAF or CMSSF is present for enlisted recipients.]

4.4.6.4. Office Call with the Deputy SecWar. Attended by SecAF, the applicable Service Chief (CSAF or CSO), recipient or PNOK, and immediate family. [CMSAF or CMSSF is present for enlisted recipients.]

4.4.6.5. Official Party taken to Pentagon Auditorium for Hall of Heroes induction ceremony:

4.4.6.5.1. Arrival of the Official Party (Dep SecWar, SecAF, the applicable Service Chief (CSAF or CSO), and recipient or PNOK). [CMSAF or CMSSF is part of Official Party and delivers remarks for enlisted recipients.]

4.4.6.5.2. AF/HC delivers invocation.

4.4.6.5.3. Playing of the National Anthem.

4.4.6.5.4. Applicable Service Chief (CSAF or CSO) delivers remarks.

4.4.6.5.5. SecAF delivers remarks.

4.4.6.5.6. Dep SecWar delivers remarks.

4.4.6.5.7. SecAF presents picture and citation (refer to **Figure 4.4**) to recipient or PNOK.

4.4.6.5.8. Unveiling of Hall of Heroes Plaque (Official Party).

4.4.6.5.9. Dep SecWar presents the MOH flag.

4.4.6.5.10. Recipient or PNOK delivers remarks.

4.4.6.5.11. AF/HC delivers benediction.

4.4.6.5.12. Air Force Song or Space Force Song, as appropriate.

4.4.6.5.13. Receiving Line.

4.4.6.5.14. Reception.

Figure 4.4. Picture of CMSgt Etchberger's Picture and Citation.



4.4.7. Sequence of Air Force Memorial Unveiling Ceremony. The sequence may vary. Refer to **Figure 4.5**.

4.4.7.1. Arrival of the Official Party.

4.4.7.2. Playing of the National Anthem.

4.4.7.3. AF/HC delivers invocation.

4.4.7.4. AFDW representative delivers remarks about the Air Force Memorial.

4.4.7.5. Host delivers remarks.

4.4.7.6. Unveiling of Air Force Memorial Wall (Official Party).

4.4.7.7. Wreath Laying (if posthumous award of the MOH).

4.4.7.8. Air Force Song or Space Force Song, as appropriate.

Figure 4.5. Sample Air Force Memorial Ceremony Diagram.



4.4.8. Tribute Video. On conclusion of the three ceremonies (White House Presentation, Hall of Heroes Induction, and Air Force Memorial Unveiling), SAF/PA will produce a compilation tribute video with photographs of the events. The video will be provided to Headquarters Air Force Personnel Center, Promotions, Evaluations and Recognitions Policy Branch (AFPC/DPPSP), 550 C Street, JBSA-Randolph, TX 78150.

BRIAN L. SCARLETT, SES, DAF
Principal Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

Public Law 107-248

Title 10 USC § 1130, *Consideration of proposals for decorations not previously submitted in timely fashion: procedures for review*

Title 10 USC § 9271, *Medal of Honor: Award*

Title 10 USC § 9277, *Medal of honor; Air Force cross; distinguished-service cross; distinguished-service medal; silver star: replacement*

Title 10 USC § 9284, *Medal of honor: duplicate medal*

Title 10 USC § 9285, *Medal of honor: presentation of Medal of Honor Flag*

DoDI 5400.11, *DoD Privacy and Civil Liberties Programs*, 29 January 2019

DoDM 1348.33, Volume 1, *Manual of Military Decorations and Awards: Medal of Honor*, 21 December 2016

DAFPD 36-28, *Awards Program*, 24 May 2021

HAFMD 1-24, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Manpower and Reserve Affairs)*, 28 January 2019

DAFI 36-2023, *The Secretary of the Air Force Personnel Council (SAFPC)*, 3 June 2022

DAFI 36-2903, *Dress and Personal Appearance of Department of the Air Force Personnel*, 29 February 2024

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards Criteria and Procedures*, 27 October 2022

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*

DAF Form 1168, *Statement of Suspect/Witness/Complainant*

DAF Form 3994, *Recommendation for Decoration Deployment/Contingency Operations*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

§—Section

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFRIMS—Air Force Records Information Management System

CSAF—Chief of Staff of the Air Force

CSO—Chief of Space Operations

CUI—Controlled Unclassified Information

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFMAN—Department of the Air Force Manual

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DOD—Department of Defense

DOW—Department of War

DTS—Defense Travel System

HAF—Headquarters Air Force

HAFMD—Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive

HOI—Headquarters Operating Instruction

MOH—Medal of Honor

NCR—National Capital Region

PFPA—Pentagon Force Protection Agency

PNOK—Primary Next of Kin

POTUS—President of the United States

RDS—Records Disposition Schedule

SAFPC—Air Force Personnel Council

SECAF—Secretary of the Air Force

SECWAR—Secretary of War

U.S.—United States

USAF—United States Air Force

USC—United States Code

USSF—United States Space Force

WHMO—White House Military Office

Office Symbols

AF/A1—Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services

AF/A1P—Director of Air Force Military Force Management

AF/CMSAF—Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force

AF/DS—Director of Staff of the Air Force

AF/HC—Chief of Chaplains

AF/HO—Air Force Historical Studies Office

AFPC/DPPSP—Air Force Personnel Center, Promotions, Evaluations and Recognitions Policy Branch

SAF/AA—Director of Administrative and Management to the Secretary of the Air Force

SAF/DSP—Department of the Air Force Protocol

SAF/LL—Director of Legislative Liaison

SAF/MR—Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs

SAF/MRM—Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Force Management Integration

SAF/PA—Secretary of the Air Force Office of Public Affairs

SF/CMSSF—Chief Master Sergeant of the Space Force

SF/DS—Director of Staff of the Space Force

SF/S1—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel

SF/S1P—Director of Space Force Military Policy and Management

Terms

Above and Beyond the Call of Duty—Exercise of a voluntary course of action the omission of which would not justly subject the individual to censure for failure in the performance of duty. It usually includes the acceptance of existing danger or extraordinary responsibilities with praiseworthy fortitude and exemplary courage. In its highest degrees it involves the voluntary acceptance of additional danger and risk of life.

Appurtenances—See Device.

Award—Recognition given to individuals or units for certain acts or services, or badges, accolades, emblems, citations, commendations, and streamers. Also an adjectival term used to identify administrative functions relating to recognition (for example, awards boards, award recommendations, and so forth).

Bravery—Quality or state showing courage; level of conduct which is expected.

Conflict—An armed struggle or clash between organized groups within a nation or between nations in order to achieve limited political or military objectives. Although regular forces are often involved, irregular forces frequently predominate. Conflict often is protracted, confined to a restricted geographic area, and constrained in weaponry and level of violence. Within this state, military power in response to threats may be exercised in an indirect manner while supportive of other instruments of national power. Limited objectives may be achieved by the short, focused, and direct application of force.

Death or Wounding by Friendly Fire—Service member(s) killed in action or wounded in action mistakenly or accidentally by friendly forces who are directly engaged with the enemy and directing fire at a hostile force or what is thought to be a hostile force.

Decoration—Refer to personal military decoration.

Deceased—A casualty status applicable to a person who is either known to have died, determined to have died on the basis of conclusive evidence, or declared to be dead on the basis of a

presumptive basis of death. The recovery of remains is not a prerequisite to determining or declaring a person deceased.

Device—An accessory or other item associated with an award (i.e., lapel button, rosette, or oak leaf cluster). Referred to as an appurtenance or accoutrement in previous versions of awards instructions and manuals.

Distinguished Himself or Herself By—A person to have distinguished himself or herself must, by praiseworthy accomplishment, be set apart from other persons in the same or similar circumstances. Determination of this distinction requires careful consideration of exactly what is or was expected as the ordinary, routine, or customary behavior and accomplishment for individuals of like grade and experience for the circumstance involved.

Gallantry and Intrepidity at the Risk of Life—Fearless spontaneous conduct at the risk of life, above and beyond the call of duty, which clearly sets the service member apart from all other comrades. Minimum level of valorous performance in combat consistent with a recommendation for the MOH.

Heroism—Heroic conduct especially as exhibited in fulfilling a high purpose or attaining a noble end involving the voluntary risk of life.

Combat Heroism—Act or acts of heroism by an individual engaged in actual conflict with an armed enemy, or military operations which involve exposure to personal hazards, due to direct enemy action or the imminence of such action.

Immediate Family—For the purpose of the MOH, immediate family is defined as the surviving spouse, children (natural and adopted), mother and father, or person(s) granted legal custody of the person by a court decree or statutory provision. Siblings will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

Medal—A term used to include the three categories of awards, namely decorations, Good Conduct Medal, and campaign, expeditionary, and service medals. Also refers to the distinctive physical device made of metal and ribbon, which constitutes the tangible evidence of an award.

Operation—1) A military action or the carrying out of a strategic, operational, tactical, service, training, or administrative military mission. 2) The process of carrying on combat, including movement, supply, attack, defense, and maneuvers needed to gain the objectives of any battle or campaign.

Personal Military Decoration—A decoration bestowed upon an individual to recognize an act(s) of valor, non-combat heroism, meritorious service or outstanding achievement. Refer to DAFMAN 36-2806 for the DAF personal military decorations.

Plenary Session—A meeting when all board members are present.

Posthumous—Occurring or coming into existence after a person's death (e.g. promotion, award).

Primary Next of Kin—Defined in descending order as the surviving spouse; natural or adopted children in order of seniority; parents in order of seniority, unless legal exclusive (sole) custody was granted to a person by reason of a court decree or statutory provision; blood or adoptive relative who was granted legal custody of the person by a court decree or statutory provision; brothers or sisters in order of seniority; grandparents in order of seniority; and persons standing in

loco parentis in the place of the parent (and other persons specifically designated as next of kin by the member).

Valor—An act or acts of heroism by an individual above what is normally expected while engaged in direct combat with an enemy of the U.S., or an opposing foreign or armed force, with exposure to enemy hostilities and personal risk.

Wound—An injury to any part of the body from an outside force or agent.

Wounded in Action—A wound incurred in action against the enemy or as a result of enemy action; and the wound requires the treatment of a physician. Civilian battle casualties are not classified as wounded in action.

Attachment 2

DISTINGUISHED VISITORS

A2.1. General Guidance. This attachment contains example guides that may be created to assist senior leaders and a MOH recipient or PNOK throughout the ceremony week.

Figure A2.1. Sample MOH Distinguished Visitor Guide for Senior Leaders.

TSgt John Chapman MoH Guest Participation Guide
(Intended for SecAF, CSAF, CMSAF)
Current as of 20 August, 1245

White House MoH Ceremony
Wednesday, 22 August 2018
Military Attire: Service Dress **Civilian Attire: Business**

Timeline:		Key Information
0900	SECAF and CSAF co-hosted office call *(SECAF large conference room 4E869)*	**Note 1:** Guests must have a government issued photo ID and assigned badge (if applicable) to enter venue.
0950	SECAF/CSAF office call concludes	**Note 2:** All transportation to the White House will be via bus. No alternate means authorized.
1445	Arrival at White House	**Note 3:** Prohibited items include book bags, backpacks, food/beverage, strollers, tobacco products, pointed objects, aerosol containers, guns, ammunition, fireworks, stun guns, mace, knives or other weapons.
1530	Medal of Honor Ceremony in East Room	
1600	White House Reception in State Room	

Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony at the Pentagon Auditorium
Thursday, 23 August 2018
Military Attire: Service Dress **Civilian Attire: Business**

Timeline:		Key Information
0900	Meet Chapman family (CSAF office)	**Note 1:** Guests must have a government issued photo ID and assigned badge to enter venue.
0910	CSAF & CMSAF escort to SECDEF office	**Note 2:** Prohibited items include book bags, backpacks, tobacco products, pointed objects, aerosol containers, guns, ammunition, fireworks, stun guns, mace, knives or other weapons.
0915	Office call with SECDEF and Chapman family	
0945	Escort Chapman family to Pentagon Auditorium	
0950	Pre-Brief	
1000	Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony	
1100	Reception in auditorium hallway	
1830	Air House Dinner (Business Casual—sport coat/no tie)	

Unveiling Ceremony at the Air Force Memorial
Friday, 24 August 2018
Military Attire: Service Dress **Civilian Attire: Business**

Timeline:		Key Information
0935	Arrive at Air Force Memorial	**Note 1:** Venue is outdoors, rain or shine. Plan for hot, humid conditions with limited shade.
0940	Chapman family arrives	**Note 2:** Restrooms and water fountains available on site.
0945	Pre-Brief	**Note 3:** Prohibited items include, pointed objects, aerosol containers, guns, ammunition, fireworks, stun guns, mace, knives or other weapons.
1000	Medal of Honor Unveiling Ceremony	

Figure A2.2. Sample MOH Distinguished Visitor Guide for Senior Leaders (continuation).

TSgt John Chapman MoH Guest Participation Guide
(Intended for SecAF, CSAF, CMSAF)



Medal of Honor Week

in honor of Technical Sergeant John A. Chapman



20 - 24 August 2018

DV BADGES WILL BE DELIVERED TO ATTENDEE OFFICES

GENERAL INFORMATION

Cameras will be allowed at all venues

Alternate means of transportation to/from the White House will not be authorized

Weapons of any kind are prohibited at all venues

FOR ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS

The Medal of Honor Operations Center is located at the [host hotel]

Ops Center Hours of Operation:

Monday: 0900-2000

Tuesday: 0700-2000

Wednesday: 0700-2000

Thursday: 0700-2100

Friday: 0700-2200

Saturday: 0700-1200

Operations Center Contact Information

Main Numbers: [number that is consistently manned]

[rank and first and last name]	**MoH Project Lead**	**[cell number]**
[rank and first and last name]	**MoH Assistant Project Lead**	**[cell number]**
[rank and first and last name]	**MoH Ops Center Commander**	**[cell number]**
[rank and first and last name]	**MoH Ops Center Chief**	**[cell number]**
[rank and first and last name]	**MoH Ops Center Support**	**[cell number]**

Figure A2.3. Sample MOH Distinguished Visitor Guide for Recipient or PNOK.

TSgt John Chapman MoH Guest Participation Guide
(Intended for the Chapman Family)

SECAF/CSAF Office Call and White House MoH Ceremony
Wednesday, 22 August 2018
Military Attire: Service Dress Civilian Attire: Business

Timeline:

0840	Load vehicles enroute to Pentagon
0845	Arrive at Pentagon
0900	SECAF/CSAF co-hosted office call (CSAF office)
0930	SECAF/CSAF office call concludes/return to [host hotel]
1225	Depart enroute to White House
1300	Arrive at White House
1305	Escorted to East Room for ceremony rehearsal
1335	White House tour
1500	Office call with President [last name] ([List names of attendees] only)
1530	Medal of Honor Ceremony in East Room
1600	White House Reception in State Room
1720	Depart White House/return to hotel/at leisure

Key Information

Note 1: Guests must have a government issued photo ID and assigned badge to enter venue.

Note 2: All transportation to the White House will be via bus. No alternate means authorized.

Note 3: Prohibited items include book bags, backpacks, mace, aerosol containers, fireworks, guns, stun guns, food, beverage, strollers, tobacco products, pointed objects, ammunition, knives or other weapons.

Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony at the Pentagon Auditorium and SECAF and CSAF Dinner at the Air House
Thursday, 23 August 2018
Military Attire: Service Dress Civilian Attire: Business

Timeline:

0840	Travel to Pentagon
0855	Walk to CSAF office
0910	CSAF and CMSAF escort to SECDEF office
0915	SECDEF office call
0945	Walk to Pentagon Auditorium
0950	Event Brief
1000	Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony
1100	Reception in auditorium hallway
1200	Escorted to Hall of Heroes and Airman's Hall
1245	Depart Pentagon enroute to hotel
1255	Arrive hotel/at leisure
1745	Gather in [host hotel room] area/load vehicles
1800	Travel to Air House
1830	Air House Dinner (Business Casual—sport coat/no tie)
2025	Dinner concludes
2030	Return to [host hotel]/at leisure

Key Information

Note 1: Guests must have a government issued photo ID and assigned DV badge to enter venue.

Note 2: Prohibited items include book bags, backpacks, tobacco products, stun guns, knives, guns, mace, pointed objects, aerosol containers, ammunition, fireworks, or other weapons.

Figure A2.4. Sample MOH Distinguished Visitor Guide for Recipient or PNOK (continuation).

TSgt John Chapman MoH Guest Participation Guide
(Intended for the Chapman Family)

Unveiling Ceremony at the Air Force Memorial

Friday, 24 August 2018

Military Attire: Service Dress **Civilian Attire: Business**

Timeline:

0930	**Load vehicles**
0940	**Arrive at Air Force Memorial**
0945	**Event Brief to Chapman Family/DV's**
1000	**Medal of Honor Unveiling Ceremony**
1120	**Load vehicles/return to [host hotel]**
1130	**Arrive at [host hotel]/at leisure**
1755	**Escorted to banquet room**
1800	**Special Operations Forces (SOF) Social begins**

Key Information

Note 1: Venue is outdoors, rain or shine. Plan for hot, humid conditions with limited shade.

Note 2: Restrooms and water fountains available on site.

Note 3: Prohibited items include, pointed objects, stun guns, aerosol containers, guns, ammunition, fireworks, mace, knives or other weapons.

Note 4: The SOF social is being sponsored by the Combat Control Association.

FOR ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS:

The Medal of Honor Operations Center is located at the [host hotel] in [name or number of room]

Ops Center Hours of Operation:

Monday: 0900-2000

Tuesday: 0700-2000

Wednesday: 0700-2000

Thursday: 0700-2100

Friday: 0700-2200

Saturday: 0700-1200

Operations Center Contact Information

Main Numbers: [number that is consistently manned]

[rank and first and last name]	MoH Project Lead	[cell number]
[rank and first and last name]	MoH Assistant Project Lead	[cell number]
[rank and first and last name]	MoH Ops Center Commander	[cell number]
[rank and first and last name]	MoH Ops Center Chief	[cell number]
[rank and first and last name]	MoH Ops Center Support	[cell number]

Attachment 3

MEDIA ANNOUNCEMENT

A3.1. General Guidance. This attachment contains an example media announcement for public viewing of the ceremonies.

Figure A3.1. Sample MOH Media Announcement.



Bit.Ly links are case sensitive

Attachment 4

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

A4.1. General Guidance. This attachment contains a template form that can be used to capture a MOH recipient's biographical information.

Figure A4.1. Sample Biographical Information Form.

MEDAL OF HONOR RECIPIENT BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

Privacy Statement

AUTHORITY: Title 10 United States Code 9271, *Medal of Honor: Award*, DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards: Criteria and Procedures*.
PRIMARY PURPOSE: The information in this form will be used for ceremony planning purposes.
ROUTINE USES: Disclosures are permitted under Title 5 United States Code 552a(b), Privacy Act of 1974, as amended.
DISCLOSURE: Used by U.S. Space Force, Regular Air Force, Air Force Reserve, and Air National Guard members.

PART I. RECIPIENT'S INFORMATION

1. NAME:	2. RANK:	3. PHONE:	4. DUTY PHONE: Comm: DSN:
5. Posthumous Award? ☐ Yes ☐ No	6. PRIMARY SPECIALTY CODE:		
7a. HOME ADDRESS:	7b. CITY:	7c. STATE:	7d. ZIP CODE:
8a. PLACE OF BIRTH (City/State):	8b. CITY:	8c. STATE:	9. DATE OF BIRTH
10. HIGH SCHOOL (Name and Year Attended):	11. COLLEGE (Name and Year Attended):		
12. DATE ENTERED SERVICE (This Period):	13. PRIOR SERVICE (Branch and Service Dates):		

PART II. FAMILY *(spouse, children, parents, siblings, etc)*

NAME AND RELATIONSHIP TO RECIPIENT (add ages of children)	ADDRESS	CITY	STATE	PHONE
14a.	14b.	14c.	14d.	14e.
15a.	15b.	15c.	15d.	15e.
16a.	16b.	16c.	16d.	16e.
17a.	17b.	17c.	17d.	17e.
18a.	18b.	18c.	18d.	18e.
19a.	19b.	19c.	19d.	19e.
20a.	20b.	20c.	20d.	20e.
21a.	21b.	21c.	21d.	21e.
22a.	22b.	22c.	22d.	22e.

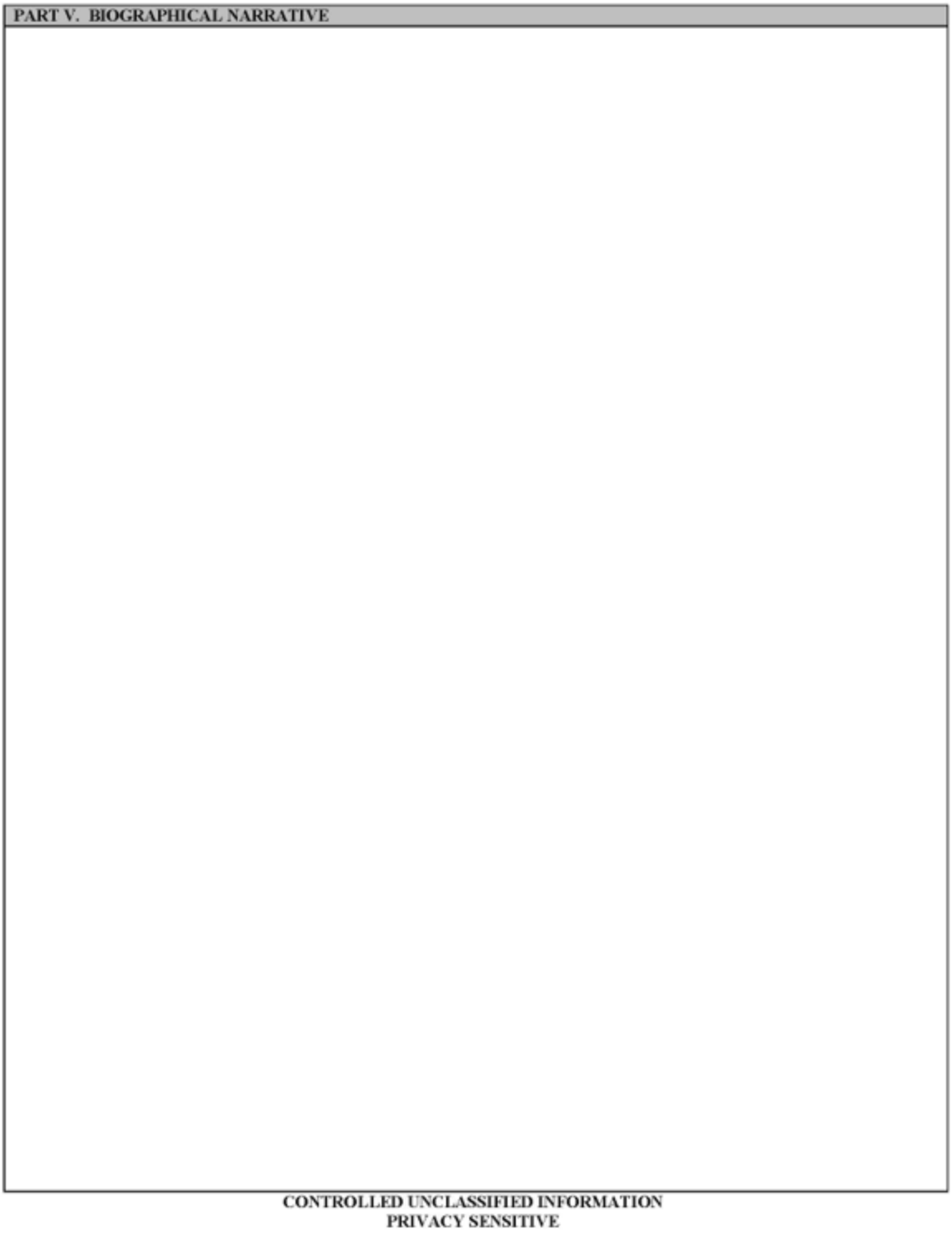
CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION
PRIVACY SENSITIVE

Figure A4.2. Sample Biographical Information Form (continuation).

PART III. UNIT INFORMATION			
23a. UNIT OF ASSIGNMENT:	23b. CITY:	23c. STATE:	23d. ZIP CODE:
24a. DUTY TITLE OF RECIPIENT:	24b. CITY:		24c. STATE:
25a. NAME OF COMMANDER:	25b. RANK:	25c. CELL PHONE:	25d. DUTY PHONE:
26a. NAME OF UNIT POINT OF CONTACT:	26b. RANK:	26c. CELL PHONE:	26d. DUTY PHONE:
PART IV. ADDITIONAL INFORMATON			

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION
PRIVACY SENSITIVE

Figure A4.3. Sample Biographical Information Form (continuation).


PART V. BIOGRAPHICAL NARRATIVE

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION
PRIVACY SENSITIVE

Attachment 5

CEREMONY PLANNING MILESTONES

A5.1. General Guidance. This attachment provides a template for tracking Medal of Honor ceremony planning progress. Due to the sensitivity of this event, all discussions must be treated as "close hold" and all information classified as Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) until the President publicly announces the award.

A5.2. Process Overview. The planning process generally involves the following:

A5.2.1. Project Officer:

A5.2.1.1. Initial Setup. The Project Officer will request AF/DS or SF/DS appoint an Assistant Project Officer, secure meeting locations for the Planning and Execution Team, assign personnel to the team, and develop initial briefing materials.

A5.2.1.2. Meeting and Scheduling. The Project Officer will schedule meetings with key stakeholders, including SAF/DSP, SAF/AA, SAF/PA, the Planning and Execution Team, WHMO, hotel staff, and the Army Multimedia and Visual Information Directorate. They will also provide necessary information on the recipient or PNOK to WHMO and coordinate the event schedule.

A5.2.1.3. Logistical support. The Project Officer will arrange for DC visitor guides for the recipient's family and friends, coordinate transportation, confirm contact information for support personnel, liaise with AF/HC and other senior staff, request escort assistance via AF/DS or SF/DS to the HAF 2-letters or L2s, and oversee room walkthroughs, rehearsals, and setup for the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies.

A5.2.1.4. Briefings. The Project Officer will brief AF/DS or SF/DS, as well as the recipient or PNOK, on the event sequence.

A5.2.2. SAF/DSP: SAF/DSP assists the Project Officer with key tasks, coordinates with senior staff, develops event briefs, schedules VIP Pentagon tours, and prepares narration and a room setup checklist (including nameplates and IT requirements).

A5.2.3. SAF/AA: SAF/AA assists the Project Officer with key tasks, funding, and hotel contracts.

A5.2.4. SAF/PA: assists the Project Officer with key tasks, tribute website, photographer, and event posters and programs.

A5.2.5. AF/A1 or SF/S1: AF/A1 or SF/S1 coordinates with AFPC to obtain the Medal of Honor medal set, flag, display boxes, and special orders.

Figure A5.1. Sample Ceremony Planning Milestones. (CUI when filled in)

Ceremony Planning Milestones

Step	Area Task	Action Officer	Task	Complete NLT	Time	Coordinating POC	REMARKS
1	**Project Officer**		Request that AF/DS or SF/DS assign an Assistant Project Officer(s) to assist with organizing the ceremonies				
2	**Project Officer**		Schedule a meeting with SAF/DSP, SAF/AM, and SAF/PA				
3	**AF/A1 or SF/S1**		Request a MOH medal set and flag from AFPC				
4	**AFPC**		Request funding for and order MOH display cases (one for the medal set and one for the flag). (See also step 24.)				
5	**Project Officer**		Request funding from SAF/AM				
6	**Project Officer**		Submit a tasking (via SSS, if applicable) to obtain personnel for the planning and execution team				
7	**Project Officer**		Establish initial contact with the Planning and Execution Team and schedule a meeting. These discussions are "close hold" until POTUS publicly announces approval.				
8	**White House Military Office (WHMO)**		POTUS notifies the recipient or the primary next of kin (PNOK) of approval				
9	**WHMO**		WHMO contacts the recipient or PNOK to discuss potential ceremony dates, allowing them two days to propose dates				
10	**Project Officer**		Once WHMO confirms the White House Presentation ceremony date, contact the recipient or PNOK to gather immediate family details, request a 100-person guest list (offering assistance from the unit commander, if needed), and provide a security form to be completed				
11	**Project Officer**		Discuss with SAF/AM transportation and lodging for the recipient or PNOK and immediate family				
12	**AF/A1 or SF/S1**		Request MOH special orders from AFPC, including any revocation orders, if applicable				
13	**Project Officer**		Request the unit commander to assign a military member to serve as the family escort, ideally someone known to the recipient or PNOK				

Figure A5.2. Sample Ceremony Planning Milestones (continuation) (CUI when filled in).

Step	Area Task	Action Officer	Task	Complete NLT	Time	Coordinating POC	REMARKS
14	**Project Officer**		Identify and reserve a location for the Hall of Heroes induction ceremony. Options include the Hall of Heroes (via the Pentagon Building Management Office) or the Pentagon Auditorium (via the Army Multimedia and Visual Information Directorate), with the Auditorium preferred due to its 350-person seating capacity.				
15	**Project Officer**		Schedule a meeting with the Pentagon Force Protection Agency (PFPA) to coordinate pre-screening and Pentagon badge issuance for the recipient or PNOK, family, and guests at the hotel, as well as motorcade (police) escort services				
16	**Project Officer**		Schedule a meeting with the Army Multimedia and Visual Information Directorate's Production Division to discuss contracting and audio-visual support				
17	**Project Officer**		Submit a request to the Pentagon Building Management Office for a permit to use the Pentagon Auditorium hallway for a small reception				
18	**Project Officer**		Reserve the Air Force Memorial for the Air Force Memorial Unveiling Ceremony (https://www.afdw.af.mil/afmemorial/)				
19	**Project Officer**		Provide WHMO with the recipient's or PNOK's contact information				
20	**Project Officer**		Identify and reserve a meeting location for the Planning and Execution Team				
21	**Project Officer**		Send meeting invite to the Planning and Execution Team. The agenda will cover key aspects such as transportation, lodging, catering, ice breakers, media coverage, the event website, and the VIP guest list.				
22	**Project Officer**		Contact AF/HC to arrange for an invocation by the AF/HC (or representative) at the White House Presentation, Hall of Heroes Induction, and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies				
23	**AFPC**		*Posthumous Only*. Arrange MOH set to be mounted in MOH display case				
24	**SAF/DSP**		Coordinate with AFDW Honor Guard for the folding of a MOH flag for mounting in the MOH flag display case				

Figure A5.3. Sample Ceremony Planning Milestones (continuation) (CUI when filled in).

Step	Area Task	Action Officer	Task	Complete NLT	Time	Coordinating POC	REMARKS
25	**Project Officer**		Order approximately 100 DC visitor guides for the recipient's family and friends. These can be obtained from the Armed Forces Hostess Association in the Pentagon concourse or by contacting Destination DC.				
26	**Project Officer**		Obtain a full-framed MOH flag from the Army Multimedia and Visual Information Directorate for use during the Hall of Heroes Induction ceremony				
27	**Project Officer**		Attend WHMO's meeting on the MOH event brief				
28	**WHMO**		Provides the project officer the date for the White House Presentation ceremony				
29	**Project Officer**		Obtain group rate quotes from three hotels and submit them to SAF/AM for selection and contract approval				
30	**SAF/DSP**		Schedule recipient or PNOK for an office call with SecAF				
31	**SAF/DSP**		Schedule recipient or PNOK for an office call with CSAF or CSO				
32	**SAF/DSP**		Schedule recipient or PNOK for an office call with CMSAF or CMSSF (*for enlisted recipients only*)				
33	**SAF/PA**		Contact the Defense Media Activity to build a MOH Tribute website				
34	**SAF/DSP**		Contact the General Officer dining facility to request catering support, such as sandwiches, pastries, cookies, coffee, water, and juice				
35	**Project Officer**		Draft briefing slides for the sequence of events				
36	**SAF/DSP**		Draft SecAF and CSAF or CSO events brief				
37	**SAF/AM**		Build DTS for recipient or PNOK and immediate family members attending the events				
38	**Project Officer**		Briefs AF/DS or SF/DS on the sequence of events				
39	**Project Officer**		Briefs the recipient or PNOK on entitlements and the sequence of events				
40	**SAF/AM**		Secure approval from the AFDW Contracting Office to contract the selected hotel. Ensure funding includes lodging for one escort to stay with the recipient and immediate family at the hotel.				
41	**SAF/DSP**		Schedule VIP Pentagon tour				
42	**Project Officer**		Meeting with SAF/PA about programs and posters				
43	**Project Officer**		Meeting with SAF/DSP about invitations				
44	**SAF/AM**		Sign and email contract to selected hotel				

Figure A5.4. Sample Ceremony Planning Milestones (continuation) (CUI when filled in).

Step	Area Task	Action Officer	Task	Complete NLT	Time	Coordinating POC	REMARKS
45	SAF/AM		Request that the 11th Wing finance office provides a person to assist the recipient or PNOK and immediate family with travel vouchers				
46	Project Officer		Meeting with the events staff at the selected hotel				
47	Project Officer		Request that the member's unit commander provide transportation for the recipient or PNOK and their family between their residence and the local airport. If the recipient is a veteran, coordinate with the National Guard Bureau to contact the State Adjutant General Protocol Office for transportation assistance to/from the airport.				
48	SAF/PA		Develop a program for the Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony				
49	Project Officer		Submit a memorandum to PFPA requesting their assistance (see step 15)				
50	Project Officer		Coordinate transportation with AFDW for the White House Presentation, Hall of Heroes Induction, and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies. Obtain cell phone numbers for all drivers, assistant drivers, and bus escorts.				
51	Project Officer		Meet with PFPA to discuss motorcade, pre-screening, and building access				
52	SAF/DSP		Arrange for Honor Guard support at the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies, and confirm that appropriate flags will be present.				
53	SAF/DSP		Request the Air Force Band sing the National Anthem and the Air Force or Space Force song				
54	SAF/DSP		Identify a narrator for the Hall of Heroes Induction and Air Force Memorial Unveiling ceremonies				
55	Project Officer		Obtain dietary requirements or restrictions for the recipient or PNOK and their immediate family				
56	SAF/DSP		Arrange Pentagon parking for VIPs (if needed)				
57	Project Officer		Request recommendations from AF/A1S for suitable entertainment or activities for any children in the recipient's immediate family				
58	SAF/DSP		Create the event narration and develop a setup checklist, covering items like nameplates and IT support requirements				

Figure A5.5. Sample Ceremony Planning Milestones (continuation) (CUI when filled in).

Step	Area Task	Action Officer	Task	Complete NLT	Time	Coordinating POC	REMARKS
59	Project Officer and SAF/DSP		Coordinate an icebreaker event and a farewell event between a senior leader and the recipient or PNOK and immediate family				
60	Project Officer		Request escort assistance via SAF/DS to all HAF 2-letter or L2 workflows				
61	Project Officer and SAF/DSP		Brief escorts				
62	Project Officer and SAF/DSP		Room walk-through, rehearsals, and setup				

DAY OF EVENTS - "D" DAY							
Step	Area Task	Action Officer	Task	Complete NLT	Time	Coordinating POC	REMARKS
Day 1			***White House Presentation Ceremony***				
			Opening Remarks				
			Reception at White House				
Day 2			***Pentagon Hall of Heroes Induction Ceremony***				
			Opening Remarks				
			Reception at hotel				
Day 3			***Air Force Memorial Unveiling Ceremony***				
			Opening Remarks				
			Farewell				

Attachment 6

MEDAL OF HONOR SEQUENCE BRIEF

A6.1. General Guidance. This attachment contains a copy of a briefing that may assist with developing slides to update senior leaders on the sequence of events.

Figure A6.1. Sample Medal of Honor Brief.



Figure A6.2. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).



Figure A6.3. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).

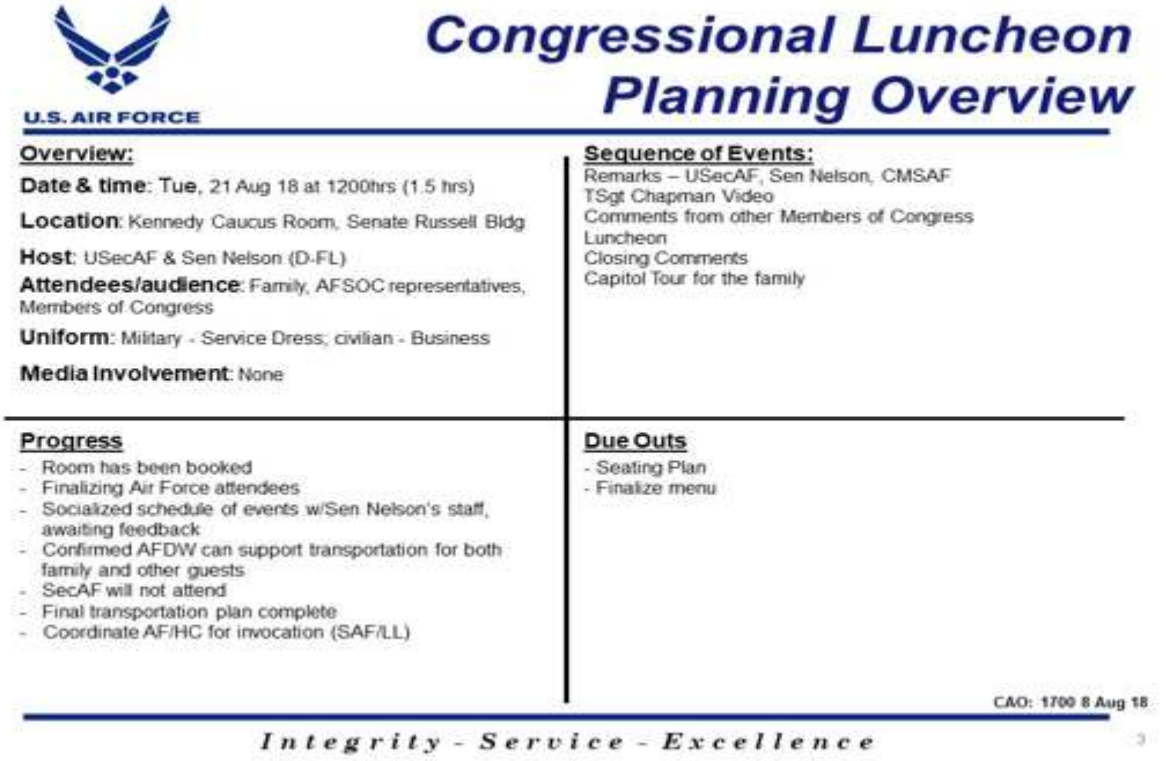


Figure A6.4. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).

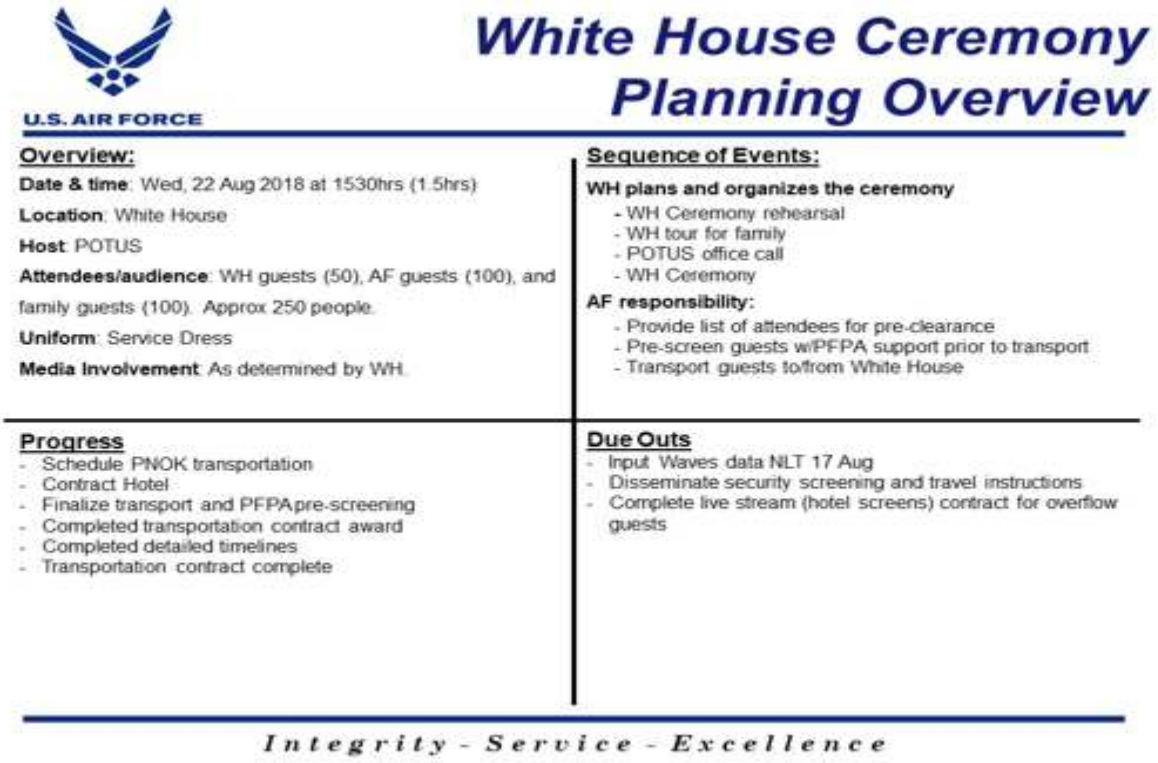


Figure A6.5. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).

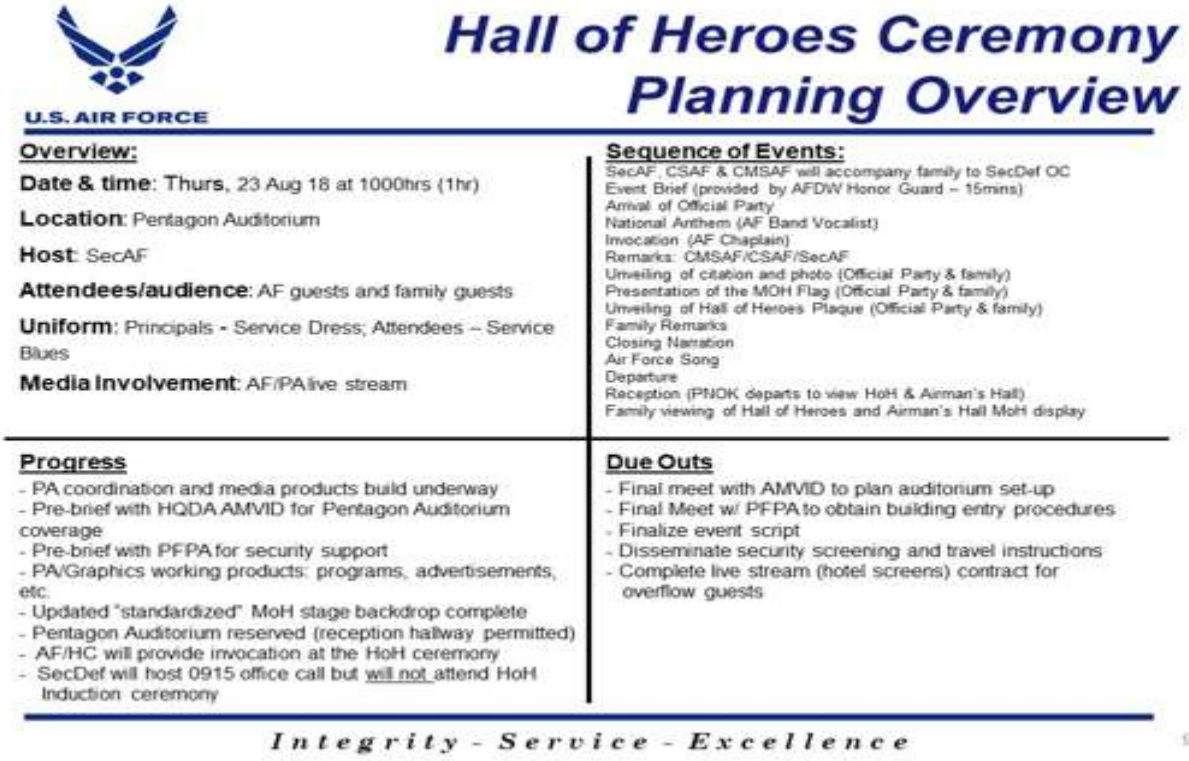


Figure A6.6. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).

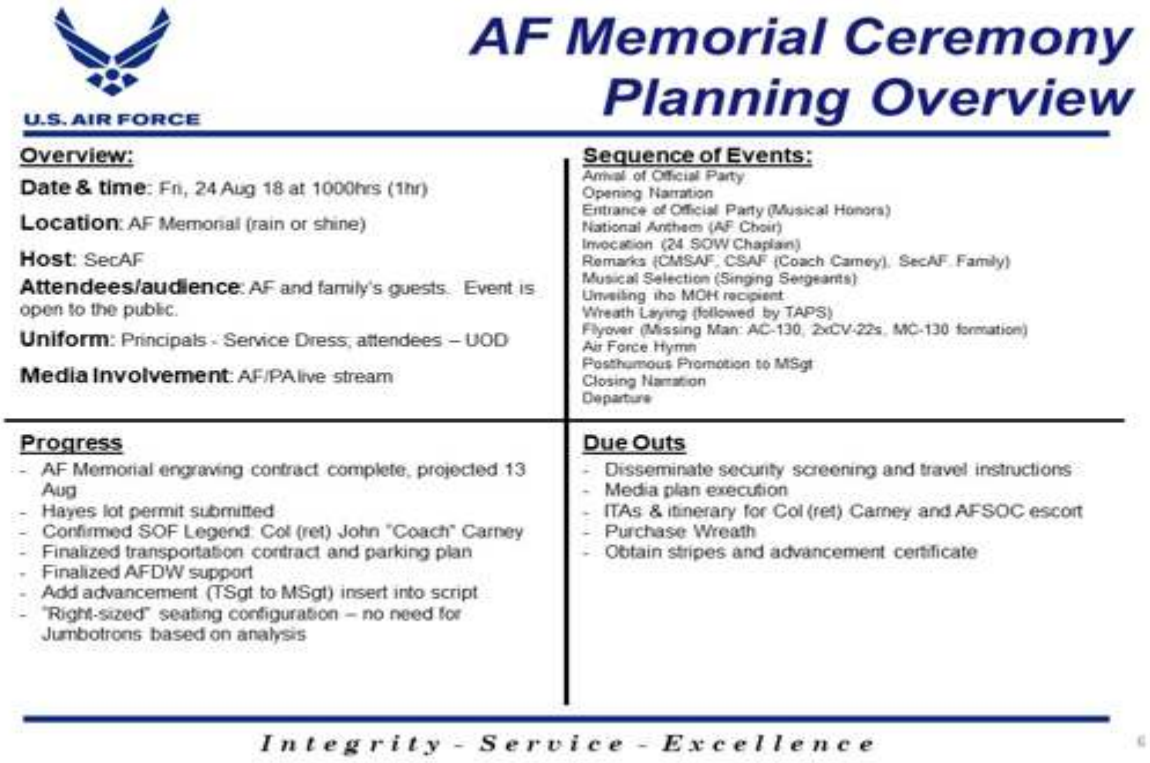


Figure A6.7. Sample MOH Brief Slides (continuation).



Figure A6.8. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).



Figure A6.9. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).



Figure A6.10. Sample Medal of Honor Brief (continuation).



Attachment 7

ENTITLEMENTS FOR MOH RECIPIENTS

A7.1. General Guidance. This attachment contains a booklet that may be used to brief a MOH recipient on entitlements.

Figure A7.1. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients.

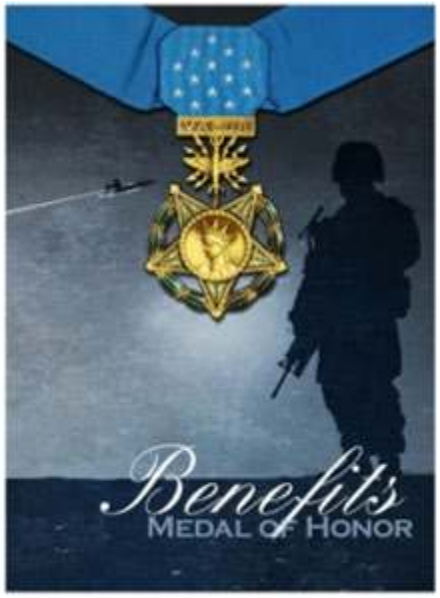


Figure A7.2. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



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Figure A7.3. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



MEDAL OF HONOR

The Medal of Honor (MOH) is the highest military honor, awarded by the President of the United States in the name of Congress. The medal was first created in 1861, the Department of the Air Force (DAF) MOH was created on July 6, 1960.

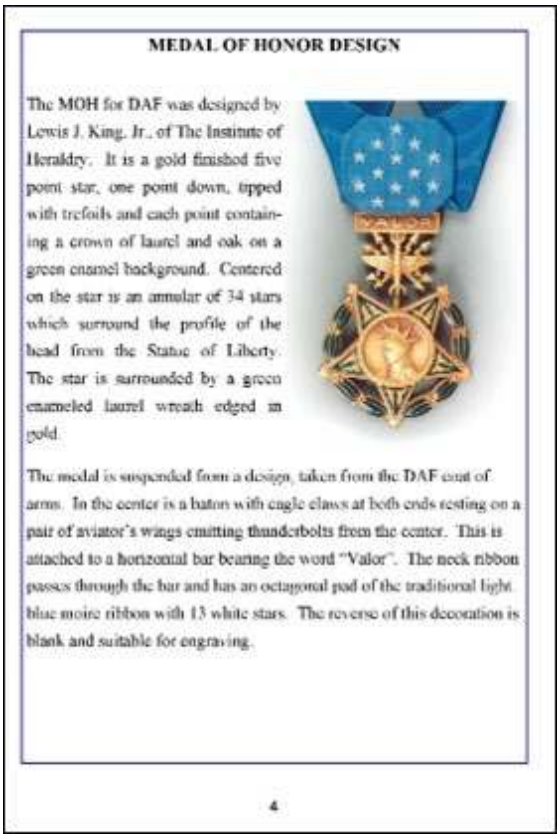
The MOH is awarded to members of the U.S. Armed Forces who distinguish themselves "conspicuously by gallantry and intrepidity" in combat with enemy of the United States.

When practical, presentation of the MOH shall be made by the President of the United States, in a formal ceremony in Washington, DC. The presentation ceremony will immediately be followed by two separate DAF ceremonies held at the Hall of Heroes and Air Force Memorial.

March 25 is designated as "National Medal of Honor Day" [authorized by Public Law 101-564, November 15, 1990].

3

Figure A7.4. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



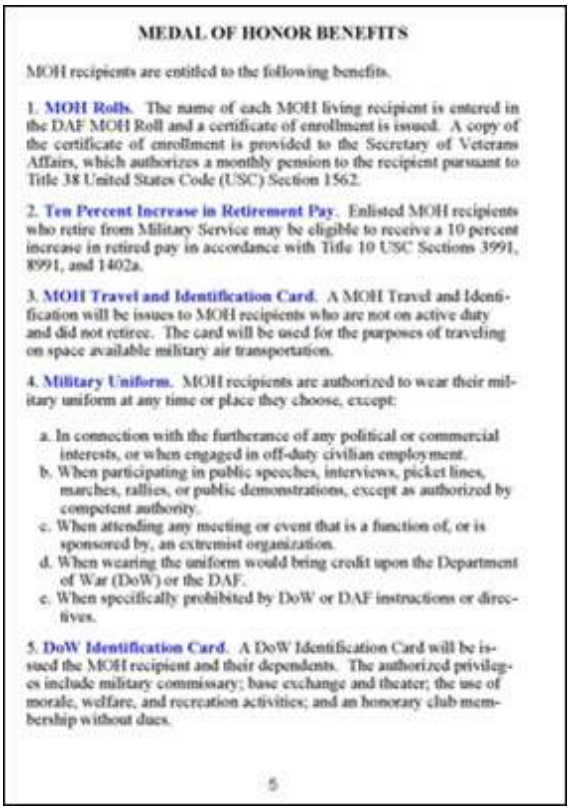
MEDAL OF HONOR DESIGN

The MOH for DAF was designed by Lewis J. King, Jr., of The Institute of Heraldry. It is a gold finished five point star, one point down, tipped with trefoils and each point containing a crown of laurel and oak on a green enamel background. Centered on the star is an annular of 34 stars which surround the profile of the head from the Statue of Liberty. The star is surrounded by a green enameled laurel wreath edged in gold.

The medal is suspended from a design, taken from the DAF coat of arms. In the center is a baton with eagle claws at both ends resting on a pair of aviator's wings emitting thunderbolts from the center. This is attached to a horizontal bar bearing the word "Valor". The neck ribbon passes through the bar and has an octagonal pad of the traditional light blue moire ribbon with 13 white stars. The reverse of this decoration is blank and suitable for engraving.

4

Figure A7.5. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



MEDAL OF HONOR BENEFITS

MOH recipients are entitled to the following benefits.

1. **MOH Rolls.** The name of each MOH living recipient is entered in the DAF MOH Roll and a certificate of enrollment is issued. A copy of the certificate of enrollment is provided to the Secretary of Veterans Affairs, which authorizes a monthly pension to the recipient pursuant to Title 38 United States Code (USC) Section 1562.

2. **Ten Percent Increase in Retirement Pay.** Enlisted MOH recipients who retire from Military Service may be eligible to receive a 10 percent increase in retired pay in accordance with Title 10 USC Sections 3991, 8991, and 1402a.

3. **MOH Travel and Identification Card.** A MOH Travel and Identification will be issues to MOH recipients who are not on active duty and did not retiree. The card will be used for the purposes of traveling on space available military air transportation.

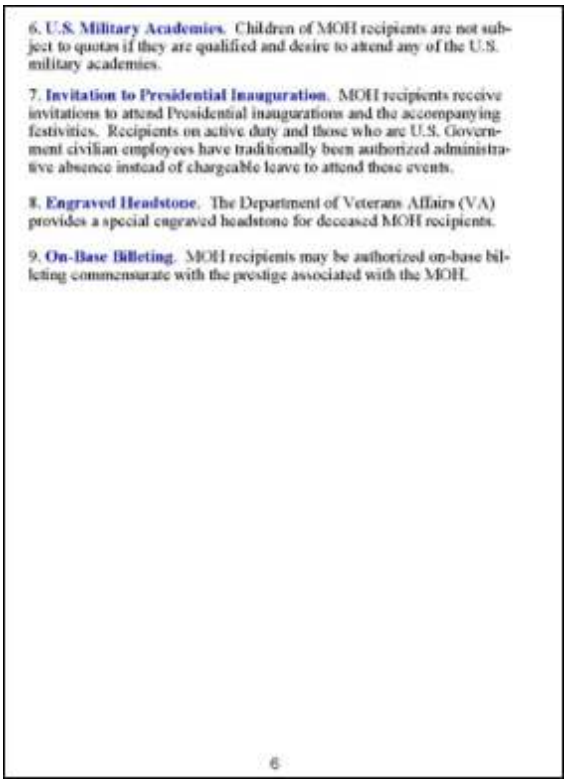
4. **Military Uniform.** MOH recipients are authorized to wear their military uniform at any time or place they choose, except:

a. In connection with the furtherance of any political or commercial interests, or when engaged in off-duty civilian employment.
b. When participating in public speeches, interviews, picket lines, marches, rallies, or public demonstrations, except as authorized by competent authority.
c. When attending any meeting or event that is a function of, or is sponsored by, an extremist organization.
d. When wearing the uniform would bring credit upon the Department of War (DoW) or the DAF.
e. When specifically prohibited by DoW or DAF instructions or directives.

5. **DoW Identification Card.** A DoW Identification Card will be issued the MOH recipient and their dependents. The authorized privileges include military commissary; base exchange and theater; the use of morale, welfare, and recreation activities; and an honorary club membership without dues.

5

Figure A7.6. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



6. **U.S. Military Academies.** Children of MOH recipients are not subject to quotas if they are qualified and desire to attend any of the U.S. military academies.

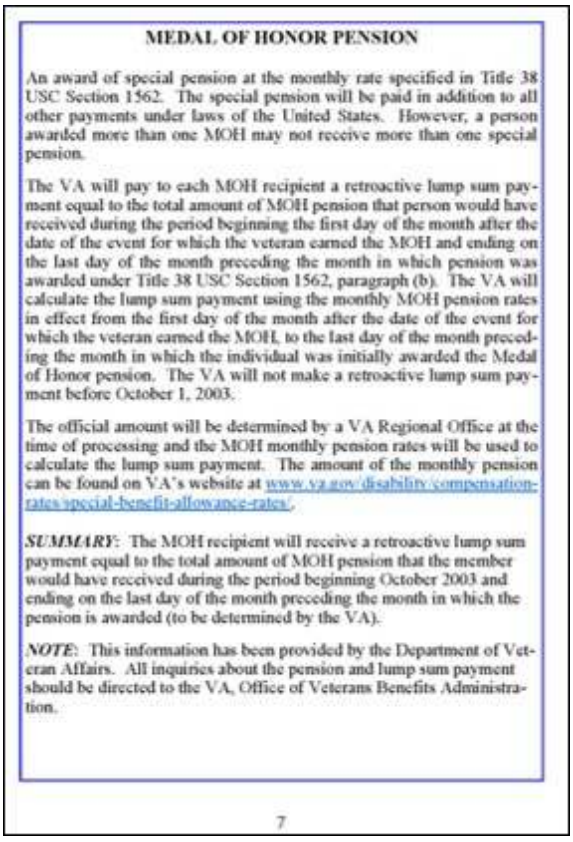
7. **Invitation to Presidential Inauguration.** MOH recipients receive invitations to attend Presidential inaugurations and the accompanying festivities. Recipients on active duty and those who are U.S. Government civilian employees have traditionally been authorized administrative absence instead of chargeable leave to attend those events.

8. **Engraved Headstone.** The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) provides a special engraved headstone for deceased MOH recipients.

9. **On-Base Billeting.** MOH recipients may be authorized on-base billeting commensurate with the prestige associated with the MOH.

6

Figure A7.7. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



MEDAL OF HONOR PENSION

An award of special pension at the monthly rate specified in Title 38 USC Section 1562. The special pension will be paid in addition to all other payments under laws of the United States. However, a person awarded more than one MOH may not receive more than one special pension.

The VA will pay to each MOH recipient a retroactive lump sum payment equal to the total amount of MOH pension that person would have received during the period beginning the first day of the month after the date of the event for which the veteran earned the MOH and ending on the last day of the month preceding the month in which pension was awarded under Title 38 USC Section 1562, paragraph (b). The VA will calculate the lump sum payment using the monthly MOH pension rates in effect from the first day of the month after the date of the event for which the veteran earned the MOH, to the last day of the month preceding the month in which the individual was initially awarded the Medal of Honor pension. The VA will not make a retroactive lump sum payment before October 1, 2003.

The official amount will be determined by a VA Regional Office at the time of processing and the MOH monthly pension rates will be used to calculate the lump sum payment. The amount of the monthly pension can be found on VA's website at www.va.gov/disability/compensation-rates/special-benefit-allowance-rates/.

SUMMARY: The MOH recipient will receive a retroactive lump sum payment equal to the total amount of MOH pension that the member would have received during the period beginning October 2003 and ending on the last day of the month preceding the month in which the pension is awarded (to be determined by the VA).

NOTE: This information has been provided by the Department of Veteran Affairs. All inquiries about the pension and lump sum payment should be directed to the VA, Office of Veterans Benefits Administration.

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Figure A7.8. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).

MEDAL OF HONOR FLAG

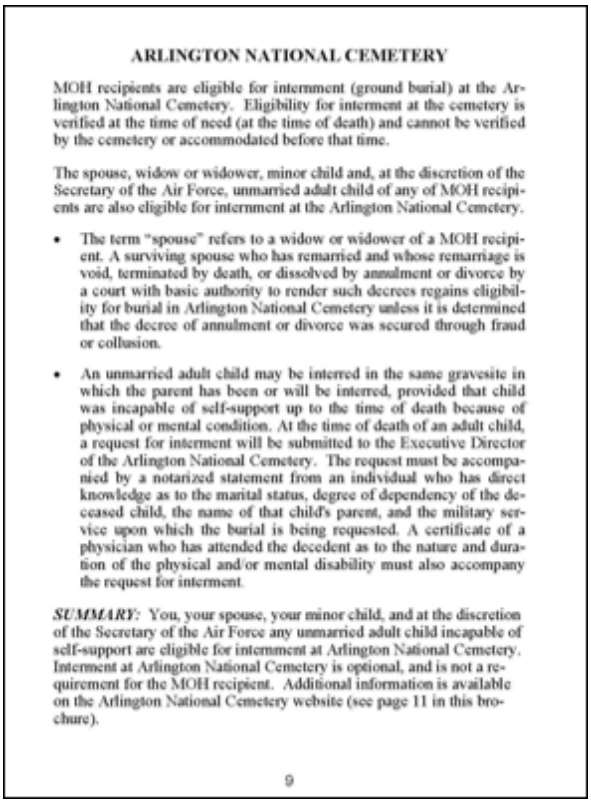


The MOH flag is a ceremonial flag for indoor use only and is considered a personal flag which recipients may display in their home or office. The flag commemorates acts of personal bravery or self-sacrifice above and beyond the call of duty and gives emphasis to the MOH being the highest award for valor by an individual serving in the U.S. Armed Forces. [Public Law 107-248 dated 23 October 2002 and Section 555 of Public Law 109-364 dated 17 October 2006]

Only one flag will be presented to the MOH recipient (or primary next of kin (PNOK)). The MOH recipient or PNOK may give or will the MOH flag to an individual or an institution of their choice; however, only the recipient or PNOK who originally received the flag may request a replacement if the flag has been lost, destroyed, or becomes unfit for use.

Under Title 18 USC Section 704, it is a criminal offense for a person to attempt to purchase, solicit for purchase, sell, attempt to sell, advertise for sale, trade, barter, or exchange anything of value for the MOH flag. Any person found guilty may be fined or imprisoned for no more than six months, or both.

Figure A7.9. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



ARLINGTON NATIONAL CEMETERY

MOH recipients are eligible for interment (ground burial) at the Arlington National Cemetery. Eligibility for interment at the cemetery is verified at the time of need (at the time of death) and cannot be verified by the cemetery or accommodated before that time.

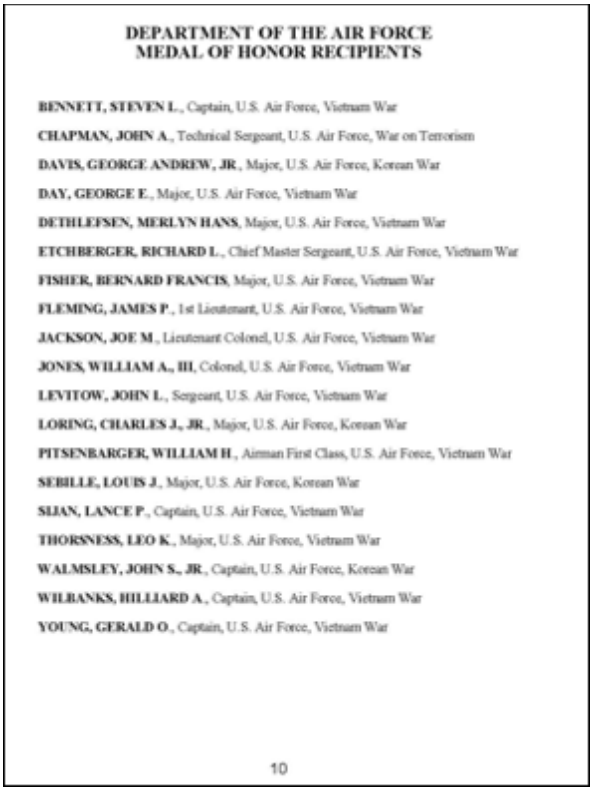
The spouse, widow or widower, minor child and, at the discretion of the Secretary of the Air Force, unmarried adult child of any of MOH recipients are also eligible for interment at the Arlington National Cemetery.

- The term "spouse" refers to a widow or widower of a MOH recipient. A surviving spouse who has remarried and whose remarriage is void, terminated by death, or dissolved by annulment or divorce by a court with basic authority to render such decrees regains eligibility for burial in Arlington National Cemetery unless it is determined that the decree of annulment or divorce was secured through fraud or collusion.
- An unmarried adult child may be interred in the same gravesite in which the parent has been or will be interred, provided that child was incapable of self-support up to the time of death because of physical or mental condition. At the time of death of an adult child, a request for interment will be submitted to the Executive Director of the Arlington National Cemetery. The request must be accompanied by a notarized statement from an individual who has direct knowledge as to the marital status, degree of dependency of the deceased child, the name of that child's parent, and the military service upon which the burial is being requested. A certificate of a physician who has attended the decedent as to the nature and duration of the physical and/or mental disability must also accompany the request for interment.

SUMMARY: You, your spouse, your minor child, and at the discretion of the Secretary of the Air Force any unmarried adult child incapable of self-support are eligible for interment at Arlington National Cemetery. Interment at Arlington National Cemetery is optional, and is not a requirement for the MOH recipient. Additional information is available on the Arlington National Cemetery website (see page 11 in this brochure).

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Figure A7.10. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
MEDAL OF HONOR RECIPIENTS

BENNETT, STEVEN L., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

CHAPMAN, JOHN A., Technical Sergeant, U.S. Air Force, War on Terrorism

DAVIS, GEORGE ANDREW, JR., Major, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

DAY, GEORGE E., Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

DETHLEFSEN, MERLYN HANS, Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

ETCHBERGER, RICHARD L., Chief Master Sergeant, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

FISHER, BERNARD FRANCIS, Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

FLEMING, JAMES P., 1st Lieutenant, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

JACKSON, JOE M., Lieutenant Colonel, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

JONES, WILLIAM A., III, Colonel, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

LEVITOW, JOHN L., Sergeant, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

LORING, CHARLES J., JR., Major, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

PITSENBARGER, WILLIAM H., Airman First Class, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

SEBILLE, LOUIS J., Major, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

SIJAN, LANCE P., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

THORSNESS, LEO K., Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

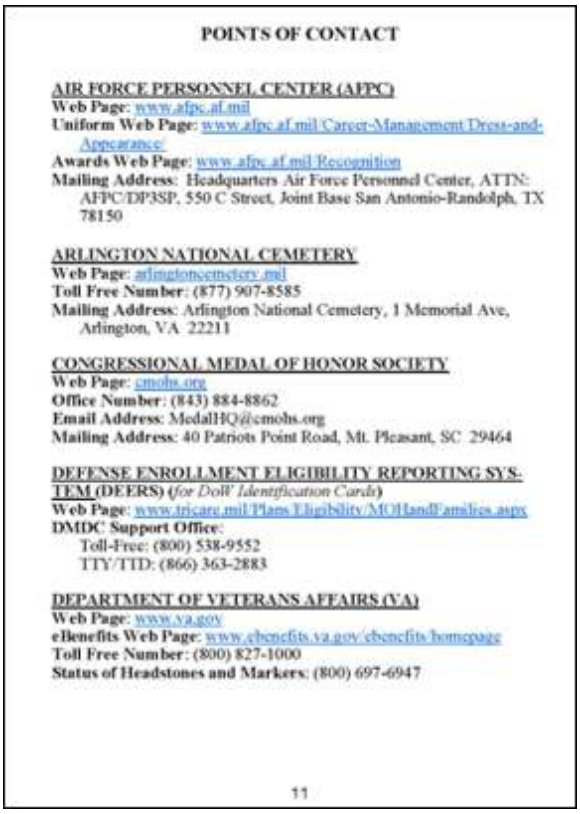
WALMSLEY, JOHN S., JR., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

WILBANKS, HILLIARD A., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

YOUNG, GERALD O., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

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Figure A7.11. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



POINTS OF CONTACT

AIR FORCE PERSONNEL CENTER (AFPC)
Web Page: www.afpc.af.mil
Uniform Web Page: www.afpc.af.mil/Career-Management/Dress-and-Appearance/
Awards Web Page: www.afpc.af.mil/Recognition
Mailing Address: Headquarters Air Force Personnel Center, ATTN: AFPC/DP3SP, 550 C Street, Joint Base San Antonio-Randolph, TX 78150

ARLINGTON NATIONAL CEMETERY
Web Page: arlingtoncemetery.mil
Toll Free Number: (877) 907-8585
Mailing Address: Arlington National Cemetery, 1 Memorial Ave, Arlington, VA 22211

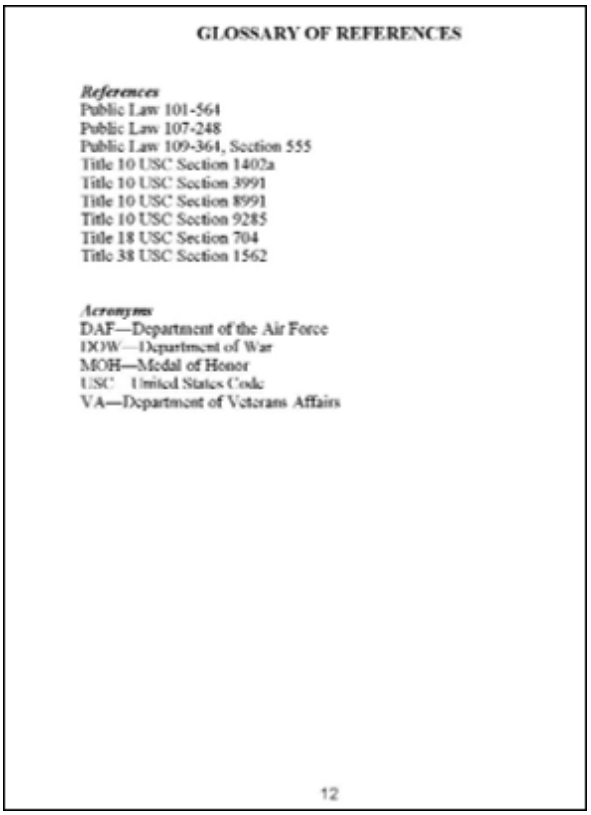
CONGRESSIONAL MEDAL OF HONOR SOCIETY
Web Page: cmohs.org
Office Number: (843) 884-8862
Email Address: MedalHQ@cmohs.org
Mailing Address: 40 Patriots Point Road, Mt. Pleasant, SC 29464

DEFENSE ENROLLMENT ELIGIBILITY REPORTING SYSTEM (DEERS) (*for DoW Identification Cards*)
Web Page: www.tricare.mil/Plans/Eligibility/MOHandFamilies.aspx
DMDC Support Office:
Toll-Free: (800) 538-9552
TTY/TTD: (866) 363-2883

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS (VA)
Web Page: www.va.gov
eBenefits Web Page: www.ebenefits.va.gov/ebenefits/homepage
Toll Free Number: (800) 827-1000
Status of Headstones and Markers: (800) 697-6947

11

Figure A7.12. Benefits Booklet for MOH Recipients (continuation).



GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES

References
Public Law 101-564
Public Law 107-248
Public Law 109-364, Section 555
Title 10 USC Section 1402a
Title 10 USC Section 3991
Title 10 USC Section 8991
Title 10 USC Section 9285
Title 18 USC Section 704
Title 38 USC Section 1562

Acronyms
DAF—Department of the Air Force
DOW—Department of War
MOH—Medal of Honor
USC United States Code
VA—Department of Veterans Affairs

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Attachment 8

ENTITLEMENTS FOR PNOK OF DECEASED MOH RECIPIENTS

A8.1. General Guidance. This attachment contains a booklet that may be used to brief the PNOK of a deceased MOH recipient about applicable entitlements.

Figure A8.1. Benefits Booklet for PNOK.

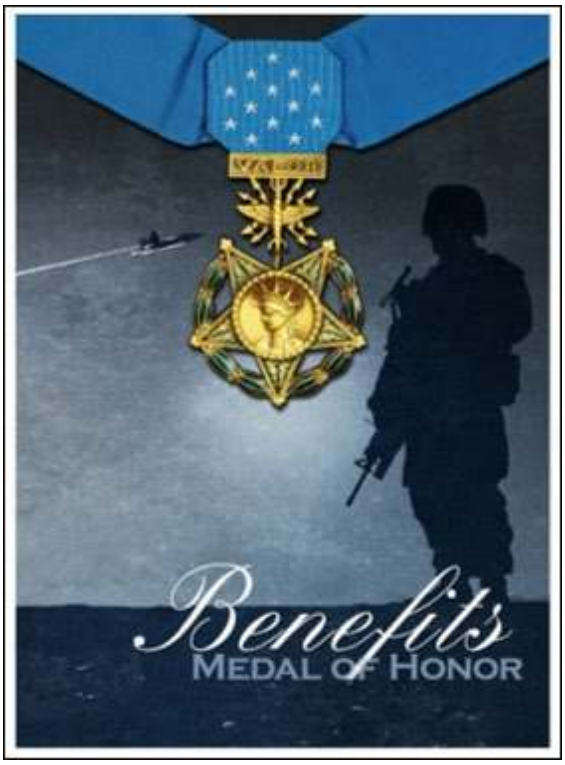


Figure A8.2. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).

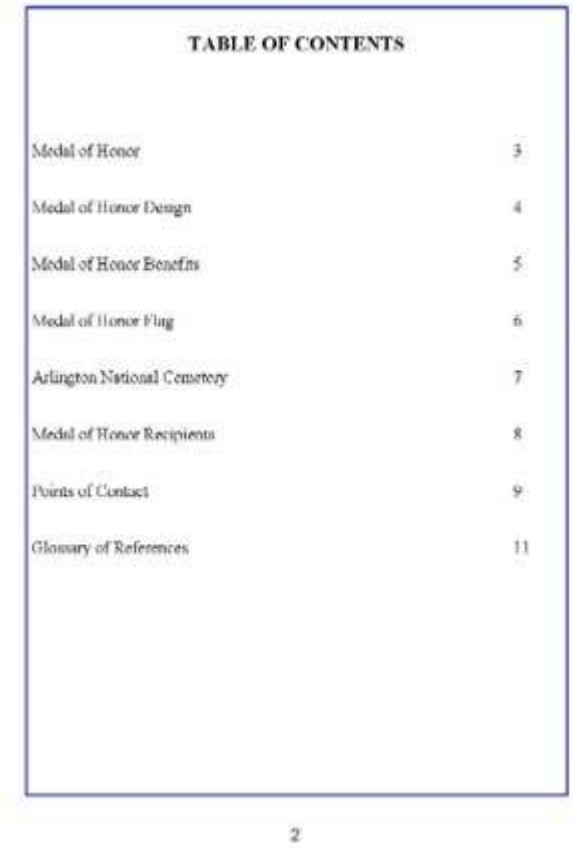


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2

Figure A8.3. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



MEDAL OF HONOR

The Medal of Honor (MOH) is the highest military honor, awarded by the President of the United States in the name of Congress. The medal was first created in 1861, the Department of the Air Force (DAF) MOH was created on July 6, 1960.

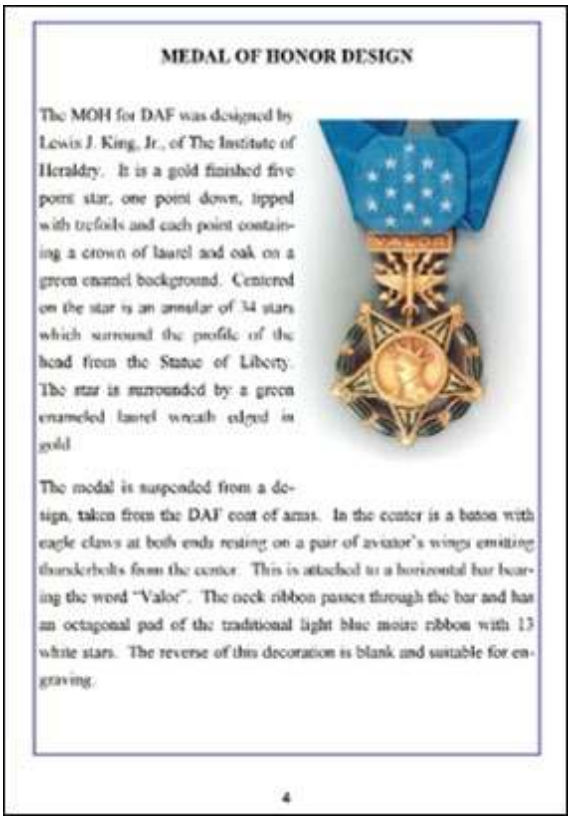
The MOH is awarded to members of the U.S. Armed Forces who distinguish themselves "conspicuously by gallantry and intrepidity" in combat with enemy of the United States.

When practical, presentation of the MOH shall be made by the President of the United States, in a formal ceremony in Washington, DC. The presentation ceremony will immediately be followed by two separate DAF ceremonies held at the Hall of Heroes and Air Force Memorial.

March 25 is designated as "National Medal of Honor Day" [authorized by Public Law 101-564, November 15, 1990].

3

Figure A8.4. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



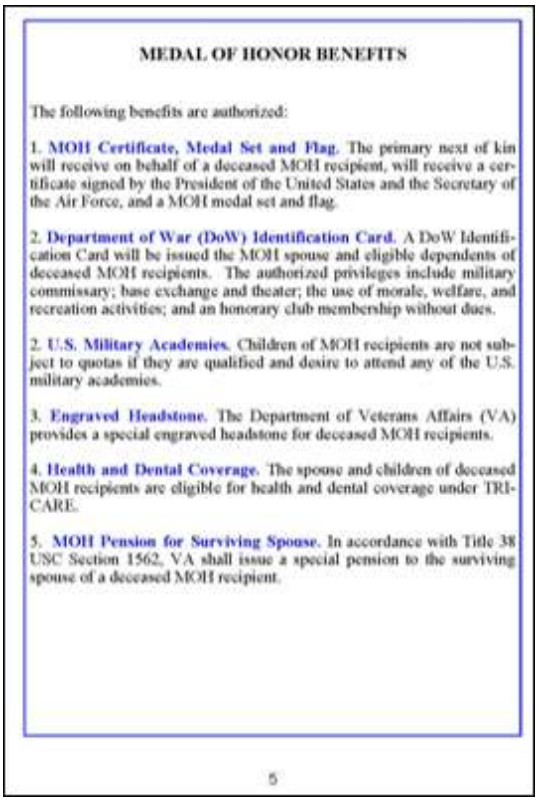
MEDAL OF HONOR DESIGN

The MOH for DAF was designed by Lewis J. King, Jr., of The Institute of Heraldry. It is a gold finished five point star, one point down, tipped with trefoils and each point containing a crown of laurel and oak on a green enamel background. Centered on the star is an annular of 34 stars which surround the profile of the head from the Statue of Liberty. The star is surrounded by a green enameled laurel wreath edged in gold.

The medal is suspended from a design, taken from the DAF coat of arms. In the center is a baton with eagle claws at both ends resting on a pair of aviator's wings emitting thunderbolts from the center. This is attached to a horizontal bar bearing the word "Valor". The neck ribbon passes through the bar and has an octagonal pad of the traditional light blue moire ribbon with 13 white stars. The reverse of this decoration is blank and suitable for engraving.

4

Figure A8.5. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



MEDAL OF HONOR BENEFITS

The following benefits are authorized:

1. **MOH Certificate, Medal Set and Flag.** The primary next of kin will receive on behalf of a deceased MOH recipient, will receive a certificate signed by the President of the United States and the Secretary of the Air Force, and a MOH medal set and flag.

2. **Department of War (DoW) Identification Card.** A DoW Identification Card will be issued the MOH spouse and eligible dependents of deceased MOH recipients. The authorized privileges include military commissary; base exchange and theater; the use of morale, welfare, and recreation activities; and an honorary club membership without dues.

2. **U.S. Military Academies.** Children of MOH recipients are not subject to quotas if they are qualified and desire to attend any of the U.S. military academies.

3. **Engraved Headstone.** The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) provides a special engraved headstone for deceased MOH recipients.

4. **Health and Dental Coverage.** The spouse and children of deceased MOH recipients are eligible for health and dental coverage under TRICARE.

5. **MOH Pension for Surviving Spouse.** In accordance with Title 38 USC Section 1562, VA shall issue a special pension to the surviving spouse of a deceased MOH recipient.

5

Figure A8.6. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



MEDAL OF HONOR FLAG

The MOH flag is a ceremonial flag for indoor use only and is considered a personal flag which recipients may display in their home or office. The flag commemorates acts of personal bravery or self-sacrifice above and beyond the call of duty and gives emphasis to the MOH being the highest award for valor by an individual serving in the U.S. Armed Forces. [Public Law 107-248 dated 23 October 2002 and Section 555 of Public Law 109-364 dated 17 October 2006]

Only one flag will be presented to the MOH recipient (or primary next of kin (PNOK)). The MOH recipient or PNOK may give or will the MOH flag to an individual or an institution of their choice; however, only the recipient or PNOK who originally received the flag may request a replacement if the flag has been lost, destroyed, or becomes unfit for use.

Under Title 18 U.S.C., Section 704, it is a criminal offense for a person to attempt to purchase, solicit for purchase, sell, attempt to sell, advertise for sale, trade, barter, or exchange anything of value for the MOH flag. Any person found guilty may be fined or imprisoned for no more than six months, or both.

6

Figure A8.7. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



ARLINGTON NATIONAL CEMETERY

MOH recipients are eligible for interment (ground burial) at the Arlington National Cemetery. Eligibility for interment at the cemetery is verified at the time of need (at the time of death) and cannot be verified by the cemetery or accommodated before that time.

The spouse, widow or widower, minor child and, at the discretion of the Secretary of the Air Force, unmarried adult child of any of MOH recipients are also eligible for interment at the Arlington National Cemetery.

- The term "spouse" refers to a widow or widower of a MOH recipient. A surviving spouse who has remarried and whose remarriage is void, terminated by death, or dissolved by annulment or divorce by a court with basic authority to render such decrees regains eligibility for burial in Arlington National Cemetery unless it is determined that the decree of annulment or divorce was secured through fraud or collusion.
- An unmarried adult child may be interred in the same gravesite in which the parent has been or will be interred, provided that child was incapable of self-support up to the time of death because of physical or mental condition. At the time of death of an adult child, a request for interment will be submitted to the Executive Director of the Arlington National Cemetery. The request must be accompanied by a notarized statement from an individual who has direct knowledge as to the marital status, degree of dependency of the deceased child, the name of that child's parent, and the military service upon which the burial is being requested. A certificate of a physician who has attended the decedent as to the nature and duration of the physical and/or mental disability must also accompany the request for interment.

SUMMARY: The MOH recipient, the spouse, the minor child, and at the discretion of the Secretary of the Air Force any unmarried adult child incapable of self-support are eligible for interment at Arlington National Cemetery. Interment at Arlington National Cemetery is optional, and is not a requirement for the MOH recipient. Additional information is available on the Arlington National Cemetery website (see page 9 in this brochure).

7

Figure A8.8. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
MEDAL OF HONOR RECIPIENTS

BENNETT, STEVEN L., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

CHAPMAN, JOHN A., Technical Sergeant, U.S. Air Force, War on Terrorism

DAVIS, GEORGE ANDREW, JR., Major, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

DAY, GEORGE E., Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

DETHLEFSEN, MERLYN HANS, Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

ETCHBERGER, RICHARD L., Chief Master Sergeant, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

FISHER, BERNARD FRANCIS, Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

FLEMING, JAMES P., 1st Lieutenant, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

JACKSON, JOE M., Lieutenant Colonel, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

JONES, WILLIAM A., III, Colonel, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

LEVITOW, JOHN L., Sergeant, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

LORING, CHARLES J., JR., Major, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

PITSENBARGER, WILLIAM H., Airman First Class, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

SEBILLE, LOUIS J., Major, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

SLIAN, LANCE P., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

THORSNESS, LEO K., Major, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

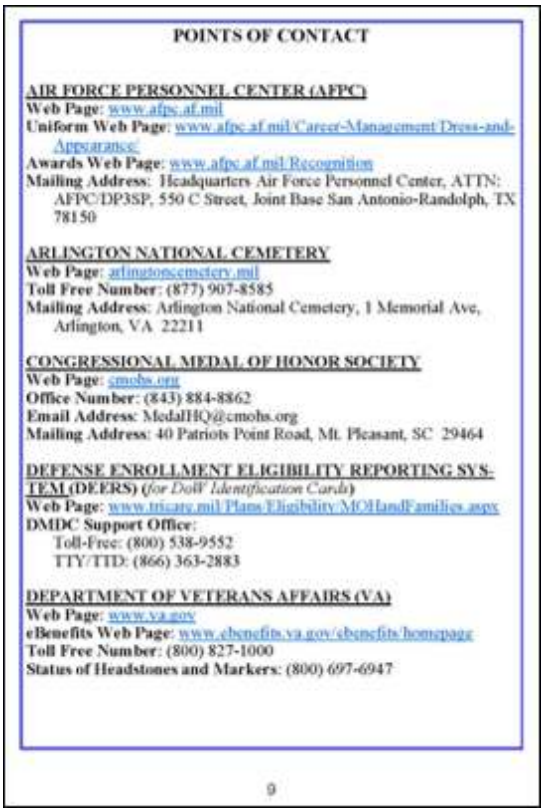
WALMSLEY, JOHN S., JR., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Korean War

WILBANKS, HILLIARD A., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

YOUNG, GERALD O., Captain, U.S. Air Force, Vietnam War

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Figure A8.9. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



POINTS OF CONTACT

AIR FORCE PERSONNEL CENTER (AFPC)
Web Page: www.afpc.af.mil
Uniform Web Page: www.afpc.af.mil/Career-Management/Dress-and-Appearance/
Awards Web Page: www.afpc.af.mil/Recognition
Mailing Address: Headquarters Air Force Personnel Center, ATTN: AFPC/DP3SP, 550 C Street, Joint Base San Antonio-Randolph, TX 78150

ARLINGTON NATIONAL CEMETERY
Web Page: arlingtoncemetery.mil
Toll Free Number: (877) 907-8585
Mailing Address: Arlington National Cemetery, 1 Memorial Ave, Arlington, VA 22211

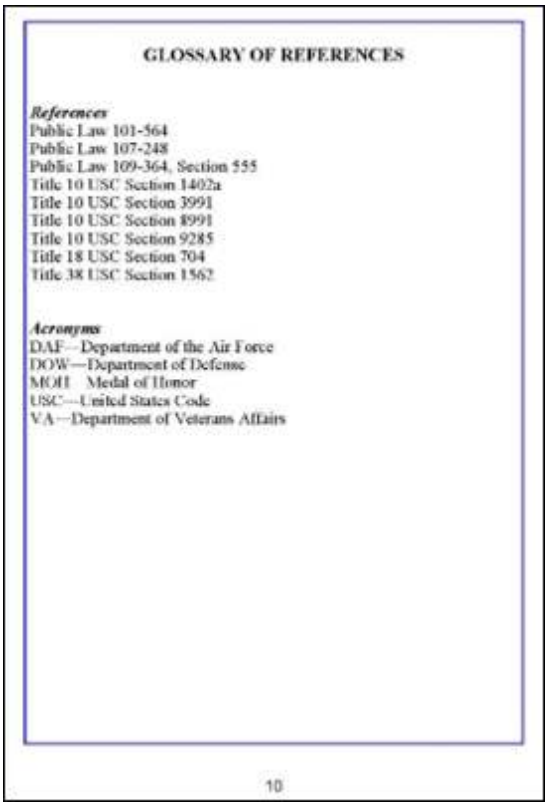
CONGRESSIONAL MEDAL OF HONOR SOCIETY
Web Page: cmohs.org
Office Number: (843) 884-8862
Email Address: MedalHQ@cmohs.org
Mailing Address: 40 Patriots Point Road, Mt. Pleasant, SC 29464

DEFENSE ENROLLMENT ELIGIBILITY REPORTING SYSTEM (DEERS) *(for DoW Identification Cards)*
Web Page: www.tricare.mil/Plans/Eligibility/MOHandFamilies.aspx
DMDC Support Office:
Toll-Free: (800) 538-9552
TTY/TTD: (866) 363-2883

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS (VA)
Web Page: www.va.gov
eBenefits Web Page: www.ebenefits.va.gov/ebenefits/homepage
Toll Free Number: (800) 827-1000
Status of Headstones and Markers: (800) 697-6947

9

Figure A8.10. Benefits Booklet for a PNOK (continuation).



GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES

References
Public Law 101-564
Public Law 107-248
Public Law 109-364, Section 555
Title 10 USC Section 1402a
Title 10 USC Section 3991
Title 10 USC Section 8991
Title 10 USC Section 9285
Title 18 USC Section 704
Title 38 USC Section 1562

Acronyms
DAF—Department of the Air Force
DOW—Department of Defense
MOH Medal of Honor
USC—United States Code
VA—Department of Veterans Affairs

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